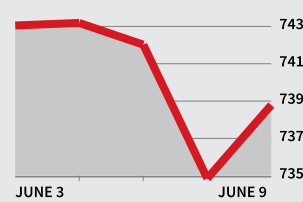


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 73918.76 (+394.50)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23242.10	+119.10
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.00	+0.10
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.35	-0.35
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	151908.00	+1026
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	245938.00	+1638

TARGET SET.

BJP sets sights on Punjab polls, readies delimitation offensive; party President Nitin Nabin to visit the State later this month **p11**



NEW ROUTE.

With GCC boom apace, IT firms are adopting the BOT model to create new revenue streams **p9**

QUICKLY.

TRANSPARENT TRADING



Govt notifies rules to establish coal exchanges

New Delhi: Paving the way for setting up coal exchanges, the government said it has notified the Coal Exchange Rules, 2026, which will enable transparent, market-driven price discovery and boost efficiency. The recently enacted Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2025, introduced the concept of a mineral exchange and empowered the Centre to promote transparent and efficient trading of minerals, the Coal Ministry said. **p3**

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To hold fuel prices, OMCs got ₹1.23 lakh cr support

WAR EFFECT. Fertilizer Ministry has sought double the subsidy allocation

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The government provided nearly ₹1.23 lakh crore to support state-run oil marketing companies hold fuel prices for 78 days following the West Asia crisis, top officials said on Tuesday.

Concurrently, the Fertilizer Ministry has sought a near 100 per cent increase in subsidy support over its budgeted outlay, which amounts to an additional allocation of approximately ₹3.4 lakh crore.

FISCAL CUSHION

The substantial fiscal cushion provided to the energy sector underscores the intensity of the external shocks hitting India's import bills. "Oil marketing companies are still incurring losses of ₹650 crore per day for selling fuel at a lower rate than the prevailing global crude prices," said a senior official.

The financial cushion was necessary even though oil marketing companies raised

GROWING CONCERN

- Oil marketing companies are incurring a loss of ₹650 crore per day for selling fuel lower than the global rate
- The Fertilizer Ministry has sought about ₹3.4 lakh crore of subsidy allocation
- The subsidy on each bag of urea has increased from about ₹2,900 to around ₹4,500 at present



retail petrol and diesel prices four times since May 15, by ₹7.50-8/litre. Previously, the government had reduced excise duty on both fuels by ₹10 a litre on March 27.

On the fertilizer front, another official said the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers had sought about ₹3.4 lakh crore of subsidy allocation from the Ministry of Finance or nearly 100 per cent over and above the Budget Estimate of ₹1.71 lakh crore. "It is under consideration of the Finance Ministry," the official said, adding that global fertilizer supply has 'narrowed'.

"China has started participating in the supply of fertilizers now. They were not

doing so for the past eight months," the official said.

The breakdown of the agricultural input subsidy details reveals a steep escalation in retail price protection for farmers. According to top government sources, the subsidy on each bag of urea has increased from ₹2,900 to ₹4,500 at present, adding pressure to the government's expenditure commitments.

Reviewing the broader macroeconomic landscape, the first official said that while the economy is facing severe external challenges due to the West Asia crisis, domestic consumption remains remarkably strong. However, "growth is not

Will have as many AI agents as human employees over the next three years: TCS Chairman Chandra

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Tata Consultancy Services will have as many AI agents as human employees over the next three years, said Chairman N Chandrasekaran. He was speaking at the TCS annual general meeting for the first time in two years.

"At TCS, the transformation is already well underway. In last quarter of fiscal 2026, TCS had annualised AI revenues of \$2.4 billion, which is growing at a CQGR of 22.4 per cent. I predict that over the next 3 years, TCS will have as many AI agent as human employees," said Chandrasekaran.

Many shareholders at the virtual meeting asked about TCS' hiring plans in the face of previous layoffs. Addressing these concerns,



The company will not be hiring the kind of numbers it used to hire

N CHANDRASEKARAN,
TCS Chairman

Chandrasekaran confirmed that there will be decreased hiring compared to earlier onboarding numbers. "The company has half a million employees. The day is not far when the company will have half a million AI agents."

Will it lead to a decrease in

hiring? "Absolutely. The company will not be hiring the kind of numbers it used to hire," he said, adding that post-transformation, there will be need for new talent.

At the same time, he stressed that individuals need "a lot of AI skills" to be fully employed.

In FY26, TCS decreased its workforce by nearly 26,000 employees; originally, it had estimated a measly reduction of 1,200.

FIVE AI OPPORTUNITIES

Noting the disconnect between the drop in the Nifty IT Index and positive company performance, he said the disparity stems from a misconception surrounding the relationship between AI and IT services.

With agentic AI systems ready to enter enterprise workflows, Chandrasekaran listed governing intelligence

as the biggest opportunity for TCS in the AI age. He also listed other significant focus points such as updating the primary technological functions of large businesses, using AI to reimagine how businesses operate, managing and overseeing AI within organisations, sovereign AI and physical AI.

On future growth, Chandrasekaran flagged an asset-led model approach for the company, as opposed to the traditional headcount-to-revenue based model.

"Our focus is to get to double-digit growth on a year-on-year basis whether it happens in FY27 or FY28. If you are doing \$2.3 billion AI revenue in a quarter on an annualised basis, we should look for proof points for it to go to double and triple in coming quarters and automatically push annual growth rates up," he said.

Gold plunges below \$4,300/oz as precious metals complex pares all gains made this year

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Gold dropped below \$4,300 an ounce, with silver, platinum and palladium following the downtrend as the precious metals complex pared all the gains made this year. The precious metals complex, which witnessed a stupendous rally since 2024, has been heading south since the Iran war broke out on February 28.

Gold prices, which soared to a record high of \$5,608 an ounce on January 29, have lost 24 per cent since. On Tuesday, it quoted at \$4,270 an ounce at 2100 hours IST.

INFLATION AT 3-YR HIGH

Analysts said prices dropped to levels seen in December last as investors focused on the US inflation report due on Wednesday. Fears are that inflation will have increased



LOSING SHEEN. The precious metals complex has been heading south since the Iran war broke out on February 28

to 4.2 per cent, a three-year high, driven by energy prices surging to near \$100 a barrel.

In addition, last week's US job report showed that 172,000 jobs were added in May, which could force the Fed to increase interest rates. Since the Iran war broke, fears of inflation, higher fossil fuel prices, rising bond yields and fears over global economic growth have dragged gold and other precious metals.

"The US inflation data due on Wednesday will be crucial in shaping expectations around future Federal Reserve policy," said Jateen Trivedi, Vice-President, Research Analyst - Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities.

Gold has lost nearly 10 per cent month-on-month, while silver prices have plunged 25 per cent. The white precious metal was quoted at \$65.50 an ounce. Gold has now lost nearly a

per cent this year, while silver's loss for the year is 24 per cent.

INVESTORS QUIT ETFs

The white precious metal soared to \$121.62 an ounce on January 29. Platinum and palladium, too, pared gains and are down 16 per cent and 18.5 per cent, respectively, year-to-date. Platinum was quoted at \$1,719 an ounce and palladium at \$1,235.50 an ounce.

The fall in gold prices was accompanied by investors quitting physically-backed exchange-traded funds. Central banks, one of the primary sources behind the rally of precious metals, also cut down on their purchases, turning net sellers in March.

From 2024 till January 29 this year, gold had been rallying on hopes of a rate cut by the US Fed, the US trade dispute with other countries and geopolitical crises.

ZOJILA MARVEL



ENGINEERING FEAT. Vehicles pass through the Zojila tunnel after the final breakthrough ceremony of the ₹6,800-crore world's longest single-tube bidirectional tunnel at Minamarg in Kargil on Tuesday. The 9.5 m wide, 7.57 m high, 13.153 km long horseshoe-shaped single-tube, two-lane road tunnel, built 11,578 feet above the sea level, will connect the Kashmir Valley to Ladakh. The tunnel is likely to be thrown open to the public in February 2028, officials said. **INRAN NISSAR**

Telcos oppose plan to de-license spectrum for vehicle-to-vehicle communications

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Telecom operators, including Reliance Jio, Bharti Airtel and Vodafone-Idea, have opposed separate service authorisation for vehicle-to-infrastructure (V2I) or vehicle-to-vehicle (V2V) communications, particularly where such communication can be enabled through existing licensed telecom networks (via cellular networks or localised roadside infrastructure deployed for intelligent transport and road-safety applications).

In a submission to the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India, the telcos said the regulatory framework for spectrum assignment for V2I/C-V2X services should be based on licensed, interference-protected and IMT-integrated use of the 5.9 GHz band, rather than a fragmen-



Telcos argue that the V2X ecosystem should be built on licensed spectrum integrated with 4G/5G IMT networks

ted or licence-exempt model. Reliance Jio said, "That spectrum should be assigned only through auction to access service providers and to authorised V2I entities, in case the authorisation is implemented. The entire spectrum range from 5875-5925 MHz should be harmonised for IMT (International Mobile Telecommunications) services and made available through auction in blocks of 5 MHz."

Telcos argued that the V2X ecosystem should be built on licensed spectrum

integrated with existing 4G/5G IMT networks, so that deployments are secure interoperable and capable of meeting stringent safety and quality-of-service requirements. "All safety-critical V2X communications, particularly those intended to reduce road accidents and fatalities, should operate only over licensed and interference-protected spectrum," the Cellular Operators Association of India said.

V2V DEPLOYMENT

Last week, *businessline* reported that the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways will mandate V2V deployment. The Ministry is working with the Department of Telecommunications, and the government is expected to de-license the 5.875-5.925 GHz spectrum band, which can be used for V2V communications.

The COAI told TRAI that

as V2X communication services rely on dedicated spectrum to enable safety-critical and intelligent transportation applications, it is imperative that such assignment ensures optimal utilisation, robust regulatory oversight and interference protection. Therefore, a licensed framework will enable coordinated deployment and strengthen spectrum management.

"Further, V2X communication must not be perceived as a narrow, standalone short-range service. It should be recognised as an integrated, layered communications ecosystem encompassing vehicle-to-network, V2I, V2V and vehicle-to-pedestrian functionalities," COAI said. These modes operate in a complementary and interoperable manner, collectively forming the backbone of a resilient, future-ready intelligent transportation framework.

QUICKLY.

JSW Steel's crude steel production rises 15%



New Delhi: Sajjan Jindal-led JSW Steel, on Tuesday, said its crude steel production rose 15 per cent to 22.93 lakh tonnes (LT) in May, driven by full operations of the Dolvi unit and fully ramped-up JVML operations. The company's crude steel output was 19.96 LT in May 2025. JSW Vijayanagar Metallica (JVML) is a wholly-owned subsidiary of JSW Steel. "Production was higher in May 2026 mainly due to full operations of the Dolvi unit (one of the blast furnaces was under planned maintenance shutdown in May 2025) and JVML operations fully ramped up," JSW Steel said in a regulatory filing. Blast furnace 3 at Vijayanagar is under shutdown for capacity upgradation, and is expected to restart in the second fortnight of June. **PH**

ED quizzed Zepto co-founders in FEMA case, UDRHP reveals

IPO PLANS ON. The q-comm firm plans to go ahead with the initial public offering

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Zepto co-founders Aadit Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra were questioned by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) in April in a Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) case, with investigators examining their overseas investments, audited financial statements, shareholding patterns, loans and guarantees, and income-tax returns to ascertain contravention of law. Prospectus The company also said in the document that they have not received any further communication from the ED after submitting documents. "We cannot assure you there will not be future inquiries or that these could



Zepto co-founders Kaivalya Vohra (left) and Aadit Palicha

escalate to investigations, legal proceedings or any possible penalties," they disclosed. "Two of our promoters, namely, Aadit Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra had received summons, each dated April 8, 2026, from the Directorate of Enforcement, Ministry of Finance, Government of India, requiring them to appear before the ED, to produce certain documents and/or provide information in relation to our company and/or themselves..." it said. While Vohra appeared before the

ED on two days — April 17 and April 22, Palicha appeared on April 20 and May 15, respectively. The probing agency sought details of foreign investments and overseas investments; audited balance sheets since FY21, owned immovable properties, shareholding pattern, details of loans/guarantees, income-tax returns and bank accounts, note on our business model, in relation to proceedings under the Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999.

Zepto said they have provided relevant information and documents as requested by the ED, pursuant to the summons, as well as follow-on inputs requested by the agency further to their interactions, including certain details in relation to holding structure, the scheme and additional information in relation to business such as business agreements and invoices.

₹8,010-CRORE IPO The company, on Monday, filed updated draft papers with markets regulator SEBI to raise ₹8,010 crore through a fresh issue as part of its proposed initial public offering (IPO). There will also be an offer for sale of 11.35 crore equity shares by existing shareholders, according to the UDRHP. Despite the disclosure, Zepto is moving ahead with its IPO targeted for a July launch.

IPO papers show growth, but profits still far away for Zepto

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Quick-commerce company Zepto's updated draft red herring prospectus offers a glimpse into both the promise and challenges of India's fastest-growing Internet commerce segment. While the company has more than doubled its revenue and significantly expanded its user base, the filing also underscores the scale of capital required to compete in a market where growth continues to come at the expense of profitability. Revenue from operations surged 104 per cent to ₹22,624 crore in FY26 from ₹11,110 crore a year earlier, while annual transacting users rose to 47.97 million (38.38 million). The company processed more than 1.75 million orders a day through 1,139 dark stores across India.

Yet, losses widened to ₹5,905 crore (₹4,700 crore). The company attributed the losses to continued investments in dark-store expansion, logistics infrastructure and customer acquisition in an increasingly competitive market dominated by rivals Blinkit and Instamart. "When you are in an expansion stage, profit is far away," said Harish Bijoor, business strategist. He added that expanding dark-store networks remains essential for long-term growth, arguing that grocery is merely the entry point for broader commerce opportunities.

UNIT ECONOMICS The filing suggests Zepto is betting that scale will eventually deliver profitability. One indication of improving operating efficiency is the company's adjusted EBITDA per order, which improved to negative ₹78.75 in FY26



(negative ₹136.15). Adjusted EBITDA per order has steadily improved over the past three years, reflecting better order density and operational efficiencies across its network. "If you want to maintain a 35-40 per cent market share and defend it against competitors, you have to keep spending. The market is becoming more competitive, Amazon is entering, and the growth rate of the overall market will eventually slow," said Satish Meena, advisor at Datum Intelligence. The company points to improving unit economics as

evidence that scale is beginning to work. But analysts argue that better unit economics do not automatically translate into corporate profitability when expansion remains the priority.

ADVERTISING REVENUE One of the most closely-watched metrics in the filing is advertising revenue. The segment generated ₹1,636 crore in FY26 (₹651 crore), reflecting growing interest from brands seeking to reach consumers on quick-commerce platforms. Meena cautioned that investors may be overestimating advertising's ability to transform the economics of the business. "Advertising is only one part of the monetisation engine. Brands have limits on how much they can spend because brands also need to remain profitable on the channel." Instead, he believes the next phase of monetisation

will have to come from increasing average order values, improving fulfilment efficiency and extracting greater productivity from existing infrastructure.

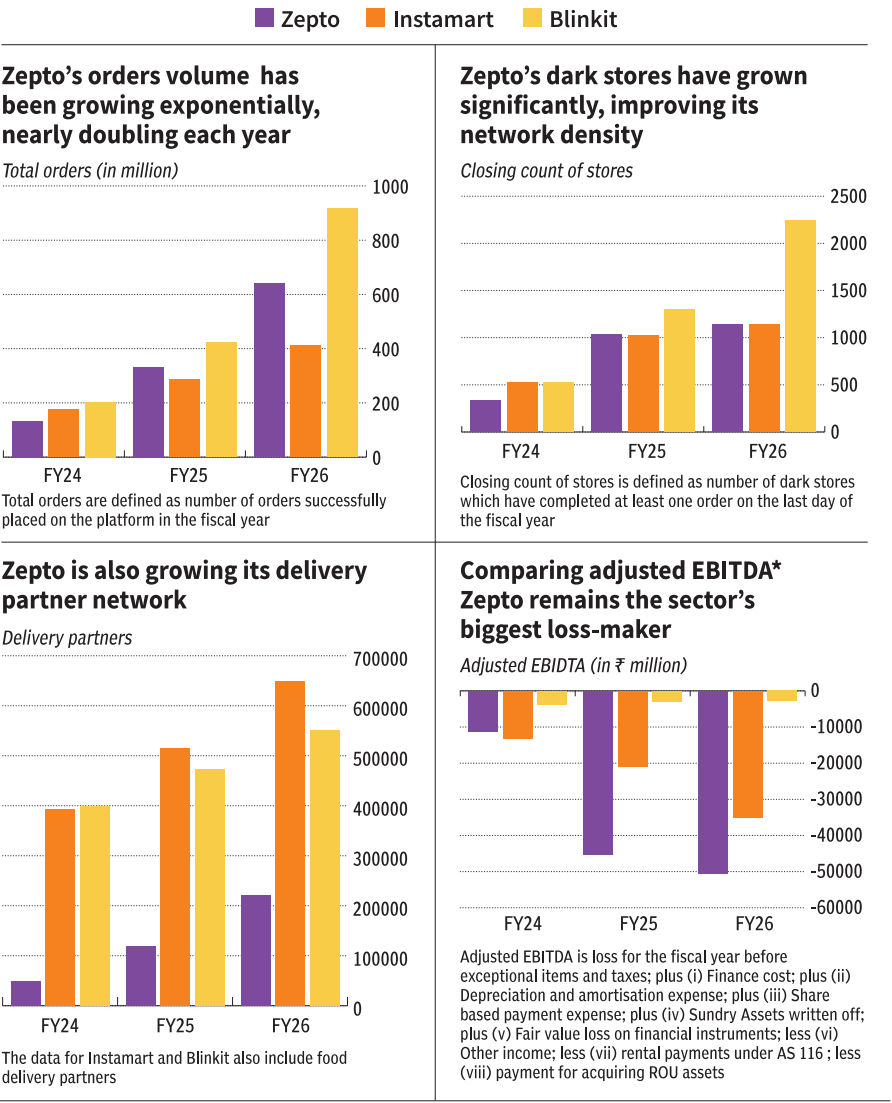
IPO PROCEEDS The IPO proceeds may provide Zepto with fresh firepower, but analysts believe they may not be enough for the long haul. "If competition remains intense and the company continues expanding at this pace, it will likely need to raise more capital later," Meena said. That observation may be the most important takeaway from Zepto's IPO filing. The company has demonstrated that quick commerce can scale rapidly in India. What remains unproven is whether scale alone can deliver profits, or whether the sector's leaders will need to keep returning to investors for capital as they battle for market share.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by **Rohan Das, Vasupradha Sandeep, intern** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

The quick-commerce battle

As Zepto gets one step closer to its much-awaited public listing, here is a look at how the quick commerce company compares with market leader Blinkit and Swiggy-owned Instamart, in major operational and financial metrics



Zepto's revenue is not directly comparable with Instamart/Blinkit due to differences in revenue-recognition practices Source: Zepto UDRHP

Mehli Mistry alleges he was 'unlawfully ousted' from Tata Trusts

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Former Tata Trusts trustee Mehli Mistry

Former Tata Trusts trustee Mehli Mistry has filed objections before the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner challenging a change report filed by the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), alleging governance failures, conflicts of interest and misuse of trust resources by certain trustees. In his submission last week, Mistry contends that the trustees of the SRTT and the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust unanimously passed a resolution on October 17, 2024, to renew the tenure of the trustees to ensure continuity after the death of Ratan Tata.

KEY ALLEGATIONS He alleges that despite this understanding, certain trustees subsequently voted against renewing his term and "unlawfully ousted" him from the trusts. Mistry argues that the decision was taken after he raised concerns regarding governance issues within the trusts. He has urged the Charity Commissioner to examine whether the October 2024 resolution remains valid in light of amendments introduced through Section 30A of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act, which prescribe conditions for the appointment and reappointment of trustees.

A major plank of Mistry's objections relates to alleged commissions and remuneration received by some trustees from Tata Sons and other Tata group companies while serving as nominee directors. He alleges that Vijay Singh received more than ₹20 crore over several years from Tata Sons and other group entities, primarily through commissions and remuneration.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST According to Mistry, such payments raise questions about conflicts of interest and fiduciary responsibilities owed to public charitable trusts. He has argued that any remuneration earned by trustees in their capacity as nominees of the trusts ought to accrue to the trusts rather than be retained personally. Mistry has sought directions for such sums to be re-

Mistry has argued that any remuneration earned by trustees in their capacity as nominees of the trusts ought to accrue to the trusts rather than be retained personally

turned to the trusts along with interest.

CALL FOR INQUIRY The objections also refer to allegations involving the use of Tata group personnel for personal business purposes by another trustee. Mistry claims that after he raised these issues before fellow trustees, his tenure was not renewed. Additionally, the filing cites a criminal complaint previously lodged against one trustee in connection with the alleged theft of a temple idol in Chennai, contending that the matter warrants scrutiny from a governance perspective. Mistry has asked the Charity Commissioner to conduct a detailed inquiry into the affairs and administration of the trusts and examine the allegations raised in his objections.

Wheels India expands patent portfolio to 125 in FY26

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



Srivats Ram, CMD, Wheels India

Chennai-based Wheels India, part of the TSF Group, strengthened its focus on innovation during FY26 by securing 26 new design patents, taking its total patent portfolio to 125. It increased its research and development expenditure to 0.76 per cent of turnover in FY26 from 0.53 per cent in the previous year, according to Chairman and Managing Director Srivats Ram's message in the 2025-26 annual report. As part of its product development efforts, Wheels India introduced new styles of flex wheels in multiple sizes for passenger car ap-

plications. The technology is expected to enable the company to offer both steel and alloy wheels with enhanced designs. Wheels India has planned capital expenditure of more than ₹280 crore in FY27, higher than the approximately ₹260 crore invested in the previous year.

The company increased its research and development expenditure to 0.76% of turnover in FY26 from 0.53% in the previous year

construction equipment manufacturers. Its customer base spans India, the US, Japan, Europe, Korea, Brazil, the UK and Mexico. The company said business conditions improved during FY26, aided by GST 2.0 reforms and stronger rural incomes, which boosted demand across PVs, CVs and agricultural tractors. All three segments recorded growth of over 10 per cent during the year. **EXPORT GROWTH** On the export front, Wheels India said it remained cautiously optimistic despite tariff-related disruptions. Strong demand from the US market supported growth in its wheels, structural fabrication and hydraulic cylinder

businesses. The company expects export growth to continue, backed by new business under development across segments. In the wind energy segment, Wheels India expanded supplies of fabricated and machined components to offshore wind turbine manufacturers globally and plans to widen its customer base further during the current year. The company, however, flagged risks arising from geopolitical tensions in West Asia, including potential supply-chain disruptions and higher commodity and energy prices. It said operational efficiencies would remain a key focus area to mitigate these challenges.

'Rapido aims to go deeper into every taluk/village'

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



Two years ago, we had a barrier of top 70-80 cities, but now we have removed that altogether and are definitely seeing tremendous results

ARAVIND SANKA
Co-Founder, Rapido



Ride-hailing platform Rapido, after spreading across 300 cities over the last 18 months, is now planning to add another 300 cities over the next 18 months, especially in rural and smaller towns where public transport systems are in scarcity, a top official has said. "Eighteen months ago, we were present in 90 cities. In the last 18 months, we have launched 300 cities and in the next 18 months, we want to launch 300 more cities, so going deeper into every taluk, every village in the country. Our focus is also how do we make our existing captains (drivers) earn more," Aravind Sanka, Co-Founder, Rapido, told *businessline*. He said till two years ago the ride-sharing applications (apps) were available only in top 100 cities across India,

but rapidly that mindset has changed and now, the reach has gone up to 400 cities. **NO BARRIERS** Rapido has around 30 lakh vehicles for rides in a month and the target is to reach up to 50 lakh vehicles on a monthly basis very soon, he said. "Two years ago, we had a barrier of top 70-80 cities, but now we have removed that altogether and e are def-

initely seeing tremendous results. Imagine what happens in smaller markets, where you don't even have a public transport — forget about Metro, which is only top 20 cities or so... That is what we are trying to do — to move people from one place to the other — and motorcycles in such places are enabling us to do because they are available in every village or a town," Sanka explained. He said since there is also

huge unemployment in smaller markets, Rapido is creating local employment. So, instead of them going to the nearest metro city or a bigger town, they can earn or can call it as an extra income, if they are already employed.

JOB CREATION "What we have also realised is there a lot of unemployed people...25 per cent of our captains earn just the college fee, tuition fee and their rent from our platform. You just work for three hours in the evening may be after their college, they can make ₹5,000-6,000 a month, which is a significant amount for a student," he added. In terms of financials, Sanka said Rapido is profitable with a growth of around 100 per cent every year. It recently raised \$240 million for its expansion to new cities and new category launches like e-rickshaws parcel delivery, he pointed out.

Adani Energy to buy IntelliSmart for ₹3,050 cr

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad



Adani Energy Solutions (AESL) has signed a binding agreement to acquire IntelliSmart Infrastructure in a ₹3,050-crore transaction that will cement its position as the country's largest smart metering platform. The proposed acquisition will increase AESL's smart meter portfolio to more than 4.7 crore meters. AESL said it has executed a Securities Purchase and Subscription Agreement (SPSA) to acquire 100 per cent equity in IntelliSmart, a smart metering joint venture backed by the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) and Energy Efficiency Services (EESL). The transaction includes the acquisition of the entire equity share capital of IntelliSmart as well as the redemption of optionally-convertible debentures held by

NIIF. The deal is subject to regulatory approvals and other customary closing conditions. IntelliSmart is among the top three players in India's smart metering sector, and owns and operates a portfolio of more than 2.2 crore smart meters across Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar and Assam. The company reported revenue of ₹621.3 crore in FY25, up from ₹243.5 crore in FY24 and ₹85 crore in FY23, reflecting the accelerating pace of smart meter deployment across utilities.

The proposed acquisition will increase Adani Energy Solutions' smart meter portfolio to more than 4.7 crore meters

The transaction, which will be funded through cash consideration of ₹3,050 crore, is subject to Competition Commission of India approval and is expected to be completed within 180 days of signing the agreement. **ENHANCING SCALE** "Acquisition of IntelliSmart enhances our scale and execution capabilities and enables us to support India's power distribution modernisation through technology-led solutions," stated Kandarp Patel, Chief Execut-

ive Officer of Adani Energy Solutions. AESL has a presence in 16 States, operates a transmission network spanning 27,949 circuit kilometres and has transformation capacity of 1,23,175 MVA. In the distribution segment, AESL serves more than 13 million consumers in Mumbai and the Mundra Special Economic Zone. The company has been rapidly expanding its smart metering business and currently has an order book of over 24.6 million smart meters.

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QUICKLY.

Modi to undertake visit to France and Slovakia



New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi will undertake a week-long visit to France and Slovakia, beginning June 13, to explore ways to expand bilateral ties and discuss pressing global challenges. He will attend G7 Summit in Evian in France on June 16 and 17, according to the MEA. In the first leg of his trip, Modi will visit French city of Nice from June 13 to 14. He will also visit Evian and Paris from June 16 to 19. The PM will be in Slovakia from June 14 to 16. “In the first leg of the visit, Modi will visit Nice for a bilateral meeting with President Emmanuel Macron on June 14. Both leaders will review the full spectrum of the India-France bilateral relationship,” said the MEA. **PTI**

Govt notifies rules to establish coal exchanges for market-driven pricing

REFORM PUSH. Move expected to strengthen the nation’s energy security and support industrial growth

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Paving the way for setting up coal exchanges, the government said it has notified the Coal Exchange Rules, 2026, which will enable transparent, market-driven price discovery and boost efficiency. “In a significant step towards modernising India’s coal supply chain, the government has paved the way for the establishment of coal exchanges in the country,” said the Coal Ministry. The recently enacted Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2025, introduced the concept of a mineral exchange and empowered the Central government to promote transparent and efficient trading of



MORE POWER. The introduction of coal exchanges marks a paradigm shift in coal marketing in the country

minerals, including coal and its processed forms, it added. In pursuance of the above, the Coal Exchange Rules

have been published by the Ministry of Coal in the Official Gazette on June 4. To facilitate this initiative,

the Ministry of Coal designated the Coal Controller Organisation (CCO) in December 2025 as the authority responsible for registering and regulating coal exchanges. Eligible entities will be authorised by the CCO to establish and operate coal exchanges, frame market rules and by-laws and facilitate coal trading. Registrations will be granted for 25 years.

PARADIGM SHIFT The introduction of coal exchanges marks a paradigm shift in coal marketing by moving from the traditional one-to-many sales model to a competitive many-to-many trading platform.

This will enable transparent and market-driven price discovery, improve efficiency and provide coal pro-

ducers, including commercial and captive miners, with easier access to a wider pool of buyers. Public sector coal companies can also leverage the platform to enhance market participation.

SELF-RELIANCE The coal exchange initiative reflects the government’s commitment to enhancing ease of doing business, promoting transparency and building a modern, self-reliant energy ecosystem. By creating a more competitive and efficient coal market, the reform is expected to strengthen energy security, support industrial growth and contribute significantly to the vision of Viksit Bharat through sustainable economic development and a future-ready energy sector.

Electricity bills set for a reset, regulator proposes fixed charges for users

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Electricity bills across India could see a sweeping structural overhaul over the next five years, with the Central Electricity Authority (CEA) recommending a phased hike in fixed charges to rescue financially strained power distribution companies (Discoms).

The CEA came out with far-reaching recommendations on rationalising fixed costs after intensive meetings with core industry stakeholders, including the All India Discom Association (AIDA) and consumer advocacy group Prayas. The authority has suggested that the final recommendations can now be taken up with the Forum of Regulators for pan-India implementation.

Emphasising that current retail tariffs fail to reflect actual utility expenses, the CEA has come out with a comprehensive report highlighting a severe mismatch in how power infrastructure is funded. The authority has pointed out that there is a “significant gap” between the fixed costs borne by the discoms and the fixed charges recovered from the consumers.

“While fixed costs, such as thermal generator payments, transmission costs, employee salary and infrastructure maintenance account for 38-56 per cent of a discom’s total annual revenue requirement, the fixed charges currently contribute only 9-20 per cent of their total revenue. This gap highlights the structural divergence between cost incidence and tariff recovery mechanisms,” the CEA report emphasised.

FISCAL CHASM To bridge this fiscal chasm,

the report recommended creating a uniform framework for calculating fixed costs, which should be adopted by all States to ensure consistency, transparency and cost reflectivity in tariff design.

The authority specified that the fixed cost component should include power purchase cost, transmission charges, load despatch centre charges and distribution costs, which include return on equity, interest on loan, depreciation, operations and maintenance expenses and interest on working capital.

To execute this transition without shocking retail consumers, the CEA has proposed a smooth, phased increase in fixed charges for retail tariffs over the next five years. Under this structural adjustment roadmap, the authority is targeting a fixed cost recovery goal of 25 per cent for domestic and agricultural consumers by 2030. Conversely, a stricter 100 per cent recovery target is proposed for institutional, industrial and commercial consumers in the same time period.

SIMPLIFIED BILLING To streamline billing across diverse regional boundaries, the apex body has advocated for a simplified billing structure. “Shift all States to standardised two-part tariffs, charging low tension consumers in Rs per kilowatt (kW) per month and high tension categories in Rs per Kilovolt Amperes (kVA),” the CEA suggested.

Crucially, the CEA’s fiscal restructuring leans heavily into changing how rooftop solar adoption is integrated into the grid economy. The report recommends establishing separate tariff categories for net metering consumers.

New-age FTAs shrinking India’s policy space: GTRI report

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India’s ambitious push into free trade agreements (FTAs) is throwing up challenges that need urgent attention, such as widening trade deficits, worsening inverted duty structures and low utilisation of the pacts, according to a new report by the Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI).

WORRYING TREND Compounding these issues is a worrying shift of manufacturing to FTA partner countries and incorporation of new provisions in the pacts that are shrinking policy spaces and influencing do-

mestic policies and regulations, the report noted. Additionally, the EU’s regulatory measures, most importantly the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), could offset tariff concessions gained by India in its biggest free trade pact that it forged with the 27-member bloc. “India now has 15 implemented FTAs covering 27 countries, while another nine agreements are pending implementation or under negotiation, covering 42 additional countries. Together, these 69 countries account for more than three quarters of India’s exports, highlighting how central FTAs have become to India’s trade strategy,” the report pointed

out. The government should set up an FTA impact-monitoring authority to track utilisation, sectoral gains, import surges and trade deficits, the GTRI report proposed. “It should also periodically assess the impact of regulatory changes and loss of policy space on account of FTA commitments,” it said. It is not just the older FTA, like the ones with the Asean, Japan and South Korea, that have led to increased trade deficits; even the new ones signed over the last few years have widened trade gaps, the report stated. “In FY25, India exported \$48.6 billion [of goods] to the UAE, Australia, Mauritius and EFTA countries, but

imported nearly \$100 billion, resulting in a trade deficit of over \$50 billion. As tariff cuts under these agreements deepen, the deficit may increase further,” it said. **TRADE DEFICIT** India’s trade deficit with the Asean grew by 381 per cent, with Japan by 318 per cent and with South Korea by 268 per cent between 2007 and 2009 (before the FTAs took effect) and 2023 and 2025, while the trade deficit with the rest of the world increased by a much lower 142 per cent, the report said. Over the past three years, India’s average annual trade deficit with Asean, Japan and South Korea has reached about \$62 billion. “South

Asia remains the major exception, where India’s trade surplus expanded from \$6.7 billion to \$20 billion during the same period,” the report stated. India’s sub-optimal benefit from the free trade pacts is also evident from the low rate of utilisation. An estimated 20-30 per cent of India’s eligible exports take advantage of FTA preferences, with many small firms preferring to give up the modest tariff savings (as average duties in many FTA partner countries are low) to avoid the compliance burden, the report highlighted.

INVERTED DUTY FTAs have made it harder to fix the inverted duty struc-

ture in several sectors (when duties on finished products are lower than on inputs) because many finished goods now enter India at low or zero duty from partners such as Asean, Japan, South Korea, the UAE and Australia, the report noted. “For example, steel and aluminium attract MFN duties of 7.5-10 per cent, but machinery, industrial equipment and engineering products made from these materials can enter India duty-free under several FTAs. Indian manufacturers, therefore, face higher input costs when competing with tariff-free imported machinery produced with globally priced inputs,” the report said.

+ ‘RBI measures on FCNR (B) deposits, ECBs will lead to inflows of \$55-65 b’

Our Bureau
Mumbai



About \$55-65 billion is expected to flow into the country due to the RBI move to bear the full hedging cost of banks for raising fresh 3- 5-year FCNR (B) deposits and providing a concessional forex swap facility to incentivise ECBs by PSUs, according to estimates by the State Bank of India’s Economic Research Department (ERD).

RUPEE TO STRENGTHEN The effect of the aforementioned measures could help the rupee strengthen to about 92/dollar. The overall balance of payment would be in the range of \$5 to \$10 billion surplus for FY27 (way above ERD’s previous estimate of \$65-70 billion deficit), and bank deposit growth could jump to 14.5 per cent, with the credit-deposit gap in FY27 shrinking to less than 2 per cent from the peak of 6.7 per cent in FY24, per ERD economists in a report. The economists noted that the current FCNR (B)

rate is 3.35 per cent (three years). At present, the cost of hedging, forward premium is 3.5 per cent. Current card rate for a 3-year deposit is 6.3 per cent. “Thus, banks can offer attractive FCNR (B) pricing in the range of 5.5-6 per cent. This will be quite attractive even if we compare with current US yields at 4.20 per cent for three years. Additionally, the deployment of FCNR(B) funds can also be done at a rate lower than the prevailing three-year MCLR,” said Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Adviser, SBI. Ghosh said the interest rate gap (between the Indian government bond yields for three-year tenure and the US three-year treasury yield)

has narrowed down significantly, reducing the possibility of leverage this time. He assessed that in case of three years, the rate gap has now reduced to 2.1 per cent and for five year it has narrowed down to 2.2 per cent. SBI economists expect around \$40-45 billion to come in through the FCNR (B) deposits route. They estimated that the ECB (external commercial borrowing)/OFCB (overseas foreign currency borrowing) swap window will support the rupee by encouraging fresh foreign currency borrowings and improving dollar supply. About \$15-20 billion is expected to flow in through this route. The economists opined that the estimated \$55-65 billion inflows will ensure that the deposit growth for FY27 for banking system could jump to around 14.5-15 per cent, against a potential credit growth of 16 per cent. “This will mean that the credit deposit gap after adjusting for regulatory dispensation will shrink by around ₹1 lakh crore. This

will ensure that the term structure of interest rates will decline further. It may be noted that in FY14 after the FCNR(B) fund mobilisation, deposit and credit growth were almost identical,” they said. The economists observed that at this juncture, the RBI may continue to ensure that the rupee is not subject to excessive depreciation. In fact, the risks of allowing continued rupee weakness far outweigh the benefits of further currency flexibility. Therefore, the central bank should continue to adopt a more forceful and unambiguous intervention strategy to arrest any dramatic fall in rupee value as it happened on June 8. They cautioned that in the current environment, a passive approach could prove costly. A decisive RBI intervention would help anchor expectations, contain imported inflation, reduce pressure on the external account, and preserve macro-financial stability.

Bombay HC refuses asset freeze plea in ₹19,500-cr EuroChem-Tecnimont dispute

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Bombay High Court has dismissed an application by Russia-based EuroChem North-West-2 seeking an interim injunction to restrain Italian engineering company Tecnimont from dealing with its assets in India in a dispute involving claims exceeding ₹19,500 crore. Justice Gauri Godse, in a judgment delivered on June 8, held that EuroChem had failed to establish a *prima facie* case for freezing Tecnimont’s assets pending trial. The suit was filed by Euro-

Chem on the basis of a December 2025 judgment of the Moscow Commercial Court, which had awarded it damages, recovery of advance payments and interest against Tecnimont and its Russian subsidiary. EuroChem sought enforcement of the Russian judgment in India under Sections 13 and 14 of the Code of Civil Procedure and requested an injunction preventing Tecnimont from transferring or disposing of assets in India. The company argued that Tecnimont might move funds out of the country, frustrating any future recovery. Tecnimont

opposed the plea, contending that the dispute was already the subject of ongoing arbitration under International Chamber of Commerce (ICC) rules seated in London. The company argued that contracts between the parties contained arbitration clauses governed by English law and that the Moscow court lacked jurisdiction. It also cited anti-suit and anti-enforcement orders issued by English courts and the arbitral tribunal. The court noted that EuroChem had participated in the London arbitration proceedings for nearly three years, and that the dispute

before the Russian court substantially overlapped with claims pending in arbitration. **‘NOT COMPETENT’** Justice Godse observed that the competence of the Moscow commercial court was “doubtful” at this stage because of the arbitration agreements and ongoing proceedings before the ICC tribunal. The court further held that serious objections had been raised regarding the conclusiveness of the Russian judgment, including allegations of breach of natural justice and questions over jurisdiction.

Backed by NEXT Investors, Transient.AI Brings Production-Ready AI to Indian Capital Markets

New hubs in Mumbai and Coimbatore spearhead global expansion



Sreekesh Menon
Co-Founder & President
Transient.AI

In the high-stakes world of capital markets, the transition from AI experimentation to production-grade reality has become a competitive necessity. As financial institutions across the Asia Pacific (APAC) region look to streamline complex workflows, one name is rapidly rising to the forefront: Transient.AI.

Since launching in mid-2025, the company has achieved a valuation exceeding 1000 crores and is maintaining a rapid growth trajectory.

Following a significant Series A investment led by NEXT Investors, the firm is currently launching an aggressive expansion across the APAC region, positioning

itself as the backbone for the next wave of institutional AI adoption. NEXT Investors (formerly, Credit Suisse Asset Management’s NEXT Investors) is a New York-based growth-stage private equity firm that primarily focuses on technology and critical infrastructure providers for the financial services industry.

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Our platform is engineered by a team of veterans hailing from the world’s most prestigious financial institutions, including Goldman Sachs, AIG, UBS, and Credit Suisse. With over **150 years of collective Wall Street experience**, the team understands the specific pressures of modern finance. The result? A specialized AI Operating System that integrates fragmented front-to-back workflows into a single, secure, and transparent platform. Whether it is traders, sales teams, researchers, or operations units, Transient.AI provides the production-ready infrastructure needed to turn data into decisive action.

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Transient.AI has identified APAC as a critical pillar for

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To learn more about the **Transient.AI Operating System**, visit: **www.transient.ai** or mail **enquiry@transient.ai**



A HISTORIC DAY, A MOMENTOUS OCCASION.



SHRI NARENDRA MODI BECOMES BHARAT'S LONGEST CONTINUOUSLY SERVING DEMOCRATICALLY ELECTED PRIME MINISTER.

Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi embodies visionary leadership rooted in service and dedication with an unwavering commitment to national development. Seva-vrati Modi ji's life reflects the spirit of a selfless Sevak, placing Bharat's interests above all.

With a transformative vision for a strong, prosperous and globally respected Bharat, he has inspired billions across generations.

FROM THE BIRTHPLACE OF OUR HON'BLE PM, L&T PROUDLY PAYS TRIBUTE THROUGH THE ESTABLISHMENT OF **NARENDRA MODI INDUSTRIAL SKILLS TRAINING INSTITUTE**, VADNAGAR ON THIS OCCASION.



KEY FEATURES



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Welding & Pipe Fitting Workshop



Formwork Yard



Plumbing and Tiling Yard



Masonry Yard



Bar Bending Yard



Scaffolding Yard



EHS Training Facilities



Residential Facilities for Men and Women

Timely support

Aviation fuel relief for airlines, a welcome move

In a timely move to shield airlines from soaring fuel costs and protect state-owned oil marketing companies (OMCs) from mounting losses, the Union Cabinet last week announced a ₹10,000-crore Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) Price Stabilisation Fund.



The initiative, the latest in a series of policy interventions by the government, will enable airlines to purchase ATF at a fixed price, thereby reducing their exposure to volatility. It also addresses the under-recovery challenge faced by OMCs by providing them interest-free advances through the Demands for Grants of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. Continuing tensions in West Asia have kept jet fuel prices elevated. Airlines across the world are under stress. The International Air Transport Association estimates that average jet fuel prices will be 70 per cent higher year-on-year, adding nearly \$100 billion to the industry's fuel bill globally. The airline lobby group has also cut its profit outlook for 2026, projecting net margins to decline from 4.2 per cent to 2 per cent.

Indian carriers are not immune to these price shocks. In fact, given high taxation and airport charges, they may be even more exposed to business risks than many of their global peers. Aircraft lease rentals and a significant portion of maintenance expenses are denominated in US dollars, and the current weakness of the rupee is exerting additional pressure on airline finances. While domestic carriers have raised fares and introduced fuel surcharges, these measures are insufficient to offset rising costs. Air India and IndiGo have suspended operations on some domestic and international routes, underscoring the difficult operating environment. In this context, the government's move to insulate airlines from steep fuel price increases is welcome. Participation in the scheme is voluntary and will help ease immediate cost pressures for carriers that opt in. From the government's perspective, it will also help preserve regional air connectivity. Oil companies, already incurring losses on the sale of petrol, diesel and LPG, stand to benefit as well. They will receive interest-free advances from the government to compensate for losses incurred from selling ATF below actual cost. While announcing the scheme, the government said that ATF price stabilisation support would remain in force for 36 months, subject to annual review or until the advance amount is fully recovered or settled, whichever is earlier.

Yet a few questions remain unanswered. Is the ₹10,000-crore support adequate? How long will it last under current market conditions? The ATF price assumptions used in designing the scheme have not been disclosed. Indian carriers have signalled their ambitions through massive aircraft orders and expanding route networks. The one-time price stabilisation fund provides much-needed short-term relief. But if Indian aviation is to sustain its growth trajectory and compete effectively on the global stage, further policy measures will be required.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



ANANTH KRISHNAN

Dozens of humanoid robots stand motionless in a row on the sprawling factory floor of Lingyi iTech. In one corner of this modern facility on the outskirts of Beijing, engineers take notes as robots march single-file and perform other tasks, from screwing bolts onto circuit boards to stretching to demonstrate their agility. Lingyi emerged as a lynchpin in the Chinese supply chain over the past three decades. It is a major precision manufacturer that supplies components made in its factories in China and around the world (including one in Sriperumbudur outside Chennai), to companies like Foxconn that assemble them into iPhones, laptops, and a range of other electronics.

In the company's journey from basic electronics manufacturing to robotics is the story of two China shocks. Starting out making components for cheap Chinese electronics that flooded the globe, it then moved up the value chain, emerging as a key cog in China's push to dominate more advanced industries. The second China shock, now underway, is seeing Chinese Electric Vehicles (EVs), solar panels, and batteries decimate Western manufacturing, which is unable to compete with cost made possible not only by state support but huge investments in R&D.

Lingyi is not done there. As is the case with other Chinese firms in this space, the company is pivoting rapidly from components for EVs and advanced electronics to an industry that many in China believe will be at the heart of the next phase of advanced industrial manufacturing — robotics.

The firm's Vice President Philip Yang tells me the Beijing factory went online this April. By the end of next year, it will be making 20,000 robots annually. It has the capacity to scale up to manufacturing 100,000 units by 2028 and 500,000 a year by 2030.

And this is just one of the company's five such facilities in China.

Lingyi sits in the middle of a robotics cluster that Beijing is building in its southern Yizhuang district. It is a hub and spokes model. At the centre is the state-supported Humanoid Robot Innovation Centre. The talent pool comes from Beijing's research universities such as Peking University and Tsinghua, that are, by many metrics, fast closing the gap on the world's best research institutions when it comes to robotics and AI.

Yang believes much of the demand for humanoid robots will come from within China itself, with state policy already paving the way for use of humanoid robots in manufacturing, hazardous industrial environments, and in healthcare. With China facing a shortage of personnel for elderly care in a rapidly



REUTERS

The next China shock

WORRISOME. The country's robotics push is backed by an already established supply chain and an industrial policy aimed at making the world more dependent on China

ageing society, policymakers see humanoid robots filling the void.

This robotics push will certainly be felt beyond China's borders, and it may well be the next China shock. Lingyi alone will be making more than two million robots a year by 2030, if the demand meets its forecasts.

It remains to be seen how, as with EVs and solar panels, others can compete with an already established supply chain, and an industrial policy that is aimed at making the world more dependent on China, and China less dependent on the world.

The global response is not going to be straightforward. Indeed, there is already rising concern, especially in Europe, on the impact of China's advanced manufacturing on European firms that have long dominated this space. Whether EVs or solar panels, Europe is looking at a 30-40 per cent cost disadvantage. Closing the door, however, may constrain Europe's ability to adopt industries of the future. Therein lies the dilemma.

WHERE INDIA STANDS

India is wrestling with similar questions, especially with the continuing surge in imports from China over the past decade. If in the public imagination,

There is already rising concern, especially in Europe, on the impact of China's advanced manufacturing on European firms that have long dominated this space

cellphones, toys and cheap goods are what India is buying, these account for a very small share of the basket. It is advanced machinery, electronics, solar components and lithium batteries that India is buying in huge quantities. In 2025, India's imports grew to a record \$130 billion, out of two-way trade of \$155 billion. India accounts for only 3 per cent of China's foreign trade, but as much as 10 per cent of China's total trade surplus.

In 2014, Delhi's idea was to rope in Chinese firms under "Make in India" to manufacture in India, rather than sell to India. India laid out the red carpet for Chinese companies, including through proposals to set up dedicated manufacturing clusters in Gujarat and Maharashtra.

If Delhi's instincts were correct, neither cluster eventually took off, and as relations soured, so did India's appetite for investment.

Investment policy turned 180-degrees in early 2020, when at the start of the pandemic (and before the Ladakh tensions), India issued Press Note 3, requiring approval for all investments from countries sharing a land border with India. Investment dried up overnight.

On March 10, the Cabinet amended PN3, allowing investors with non-controlling beneficial ownership from land border countries up to 10 per cent under the automatic route. Clearance would be expedited for investments in manufacturing in capital goods, electronic capital goods, electronic components, polysilicon and ingot-wafers.

The broader context to the easing, however, is hard to miss — the harsh

dual reality of decreasing FDI and increasing reliance on Chinese manufacturing.

The hope now appears to be to engage China just as, decades ago, China engaged Japan to bring in technology though JVs, integrate into global supply chains, move up the manufacturing ladder, and ultimately reduce reliance on imports.

Chinese firms still retain the appetite to go to India, which is seen as the biggest remaining untapped large overseas market. However, this is an appetite that has been significantly diminished after what Chinese firms see as five years of scrutiny and restrictions.

COOPERATION AGREEMENTS

An even bigger problem is Beijing's increasing wariness at allowing firms in strategic sectors to get into cooperation agreements abroad, with an eye on ensuring technology in critical sectors such as batteries and robotics stays in China. The reach of export controls is widening beyond critical minerals. Last year, restrictions were imposed on exporting some types of EV batteries. That followed battery maker Gotion coming under fire in China for announcing a deal in India that involved some transfer of technology.

More recently, automaker Chery, on June 8, issued a statement to deny it would transfer any EV technology to Tata Motors under a cooperation agreement, following a social media uproar in China over the deal. Indeed, China understands more than most what is to be gained from absorbing technology through investment, and what it stands to lose if India succeeds in doing the same.

Health report: children doing better, adults less so

NFHS-6 shows rising NCD burden, and possibly a systemic lack in dealing with it. The survey has data gaps

Urvashi Prasad

The National Family Health Survey-6 is the most comprehensive picture of India's health in four years. And if you read only the government's press release, you would conclude that India's health story is largely one of progress. That reading is not wrong. It is incomplete.

The gains are genuine and significant. Institutional deliveries have risen to 90.6 per cent. Antenatal care coverage is at 95.9 per cent. Stunting in children under five has declined substantially from 35.5 per cent to 29.3 per cent. Breastfeeding within one hour of birth has improved by more than eight percentage points. Hypertension has declined nationally among both women and men. These reflect years of sustained investment in maternal and child health — and they are working. The question NFHS-6 forces is what happens to that woman after she safely delivers and turns 35.

NFHS-6 records a sharp and accelerating rise in NCD (non-communicable disease) risk factors among working-age adults. Nearly one in three women aged 15-49 is now overweight or obese — up from one

in four in NFHS-5. In urban areas, the figure reaches 42.8 per cent. Among men, the rise is from 22.9 per cent to 27.3 per cent. High blood sugar in men has risen from 15.6 per cent to 20.9 per cent in four years. In women, from 13.5 per cent to 17.8 per cent.

These are not marginal increases — they represent millions moving into metabolic risk for cardiovascular disease, diabetes, kidney disease, and cancer, in a health system still primarily organised around maternal care. The NSO's health survey, published in April, showed cardiovascular disease nearly tripling over seven years — NFHS-6 shows the conditions producing that outcome. India also carries both ends of the nutrition burden simultaneously. While obesity climbs, 19.7 per cent of women aged 15-49 remain underweight.

THE RURAL SURPRISE

NFHS-6 demolishes the assumption that NCDs are an urban, middle-class problem. Rural women's obesity stands at 25.5 per cent. Rural men's high blood sugar is at 19.7 per cent — barely below the urban figure of 23.9 per cent. The convergence is happening fast, in primary health centres without NCD protocols, districts without dietitians, communities without the financial



DIABETES CASES. On the rise

cushion to absorb a chronic illness diagnosis.

Buried in the delivery data is a figure that demands attention: caesarean sections have risen from 21.5 per cent to 27.2 per cent nationally — and to 40.5 per cent in urban areas. More than half of all births in private facilities are now delivered by C-section. India is not just medicalising birth; it is over-medicalising it, at cost to families and without evidence of commensurate health gains. NFHS-6's most significant omission is anaemia. In NFHS-5, 57 per cent of women aged 15-49 were anaemic. So were 67 per cent of children. The government launched the Anaemia Mukh Bharat programme in 2018. By

NFHS-5, anaemia had risen — from 53 per cent in NFHS-4 to 57 per cent — despite the programme's existence.

NFHS-6 does not measure anaemia. The official reason is methodological: reliability concerns about the haemoglobinometer used in previous rounds. A survey that functions as a government accountability tool has removed the indicator on which the government was most visibly failing. We do not know whether 57 per cent has become 60 per cent or fallen to 50 per cent. However, a robust ICMR survey has been promised.

India built its health system around two priorities: infectious disease and maternal and child health. What NFHS-6 also confirms — in its NCD data, in its C-section surge, in its anaemia silence, in what it measures and what it does not — is that the architecture has not kept pace with the disease burden shifting beneath it.

The gains are real. The system NFHS-6 reveals as inadequate for what comes next is just as real. A survey that celebrates the former without honestly reckoning with the latter is not a health report. It is a press release.

The writer is Senior Fellow, Pahlé India Foundation and Ex-Director NITI Aayog

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

India-US trade deal

Apropos 'India, US trade deal only after Section 301 probe is concluded' (June 9), the US has not been completely fair in either dealing with India or in negotiating on trade deal all along. The latest US salvo is the expected additional tariff under Section 301, which is archaic and does not have any relevance for the current times. Forced labour is a malady of the industrial past of many many countries, including the US. Trump has announced the 301 investigations only after the US Supreme Court has struck down his

abnormal and varying across the board tariffs imposed on most of the US trade partners. As Trump is completely transactional in his dealings with nations, India should also adopt the same mode of negotiations and root for a trade deal with 100 per cent protection for vulnerable sectors of the Indian economy. **Kosaraju Chandramouli** Hyderabad

Raising deposits

With reference to 'Mind the gap' (June 9), the rising C-D ratios of

banks are likely to create asset-liability mismatches since banks will be forced to seal the gap through high-cost market borrowings which may drain profits ultimately. Equally, the overall investor sentiment presently is subdued due to high market volatility in all the segments — equity, debt, bullion, mutual funds and angel investments. For banks, sourcing of low-cost deposits may not be easy, due to falling depositor interest in banking channels owing to low rates of interest, mounting cybercrimes,

major bank frauds, large scale diversion of depositor money to nurture dishonest promoter groups by some co-operative and private banks, etc. Apart from offering higher interest rates on deposits, banks should aim to make the best use of the recent regulatory incentives provided to garner NRI deposits and FPI investments, to supplement their treasury income. **Sitaram Popuri** Bengaluru

Disinvestment proceeds

This refers to 'Divestment mop-up in

2 months of FY 27 tops FY 25 collection' (June 9). Disinvestment is a vital capital receipt of the government. It is imperative that it uses the proceeds for productive investments and creation of assets. In other words, it should not use them for meeting the revenue expenditure, which can exacerbate the situation of inflation in the economy. Also, the government should endeavour to recover loans given to States and Union Territories and use them productively. **S Ramakrishnasayee** Chennai

QUICKLY.

NSE to deploy 10% of annual CSR corpus via SSE



New Delhi: The National Stock Exchange on Tuesday said it will earmark 10 per cent of its annual corporate social responsibility (CSR) corpus for projects listed on the NSE Social Stock Exchange (NSE-SSE). The decision follows recent regulatory changes allowing companies to undertake CSR expenditure through subscription to zero coupon zero principal instruments listed on SSEs. NSE said its CSR Committee had, in principle, approved the proposal in March, subject to enabling regulatory provisions. The commitment has now been operationalised after the Ministry of Corporate Affairs permitted CSR spending through such instruments. **BN**

Swara Baby to file papers for ₹1,000-crore IPO soon

New Delhi: Swara Baby Products, a contract manufacturer of baby diapers, adult diapers and feminine hygiene products backed by FirstCry, is planning to file draft papers with SEBI this month to raise funds up to ₹1,000 crore through an initial public offering (IPO), people familiar with the development said on Tuesday. The proposed IPO is expected to comprise a fresh issue of shares and an offer for sale (OFS) by existing shareholders, they added. JM Financial and Aventus Capital have been appointed as the book-running lead managers for the issue. Emails sent to the company and the investment bankers seeking comments did not elicit any response till the filing of this report. **BN**

Banks steal the show; Sensex, Nifty gain on RBI booster dose

MOVERS & SHAKERS. Mid- and small-caps shine even as IT stocks remain under pressure

Madhu Balaji

Bengaluru

The benchmark indices closed higher on Tuesday in a broad-based recovery led by banking and financial stocks, after the Reserve Bank of India introduced operational guidelines for its US dollar-rupee forex swap facilities aimed at boosting foreign currency inflows and easing dollar liquidity conditions. The BSE Sensex settled 394.50 points higher at 73,918.76 after touching an intra-day high of 74,035.41. The Nifty 50 gained 119.10 points to close at 23,242.10. The markets had come under pressure in recent sessions due to escalating geopolitical tensions and persistent foreign institutional investor outflows.



INTEREST PERKS UP. Bank of Baroda led gainers after the RBI allowed foreign currency deposits at lower cost

Tuesday's recovery, however, remained cautious due to concerns over elevated global bond yields, evolving macroeconomic uncertainties, weak monsoon forecasts and rising inflation. Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments, said market sentiment remained fragile, while investors remain focused on

upcoming US inflation data for cues on Fed policy and global liquidity.

SMALL CAP SHINES

The broader markets outperformed the headline indices, with mid-cap and small-cap indices advancing 1.35 per cent and 1.69 per cent, respectively. Among sectors, PSU banks led the rally, fol-

lowed by financial services and private banks. BoB, Canara Bank, PNB, Federal Bank and IndusInd Bank jumped between 3 and 4 per cent. SBI and ICICI Bank, too, gained over 2 per cent.

Banking stocks remained the key drivers on Tuesday after the RBI allowed banks to mobilise foreign currency deposits at lower costs through concessional forex swap facilities.

The central bank also provided CRR and SLR exemptions for eligible FCNR (B) deposits, a move seen improving liquidity and supporting banking sector margins. IT stocks remained under pressure amid concerns over slowing global technology.

On the BSE, 2,782 stocks advanced, while 1,423 declined.

Bernstein flags risk to SIP inflows if markets fail to deliver returns

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Bernstein said systematic investment plans remain a structural savings habit for Indian investors, but warned that domestic equity inflows could face near-term turbulence if the markets fail to generate meaningful returns over the next 12 months.

In a report, titled *Indian Capital Markets: Markets are on a clock to generate returns*, it said they have been under pressure since peaking in September 2024 amid high valuations, weaker earnings growth, concerns around India's AI opportunity, West Asia tensions and currency movements.

Bernstein said strong market returns during CY23 and 9M-CY24 had helped sustain domestic inflows so far. However, as those gains gradually roll off from trailing return calculations, investor flows may come under



pressure if the returns remain muted.

RESILIENT INFLOW

The brokerage's proprietary investor survey showed that SIP investors had largely remained resilient despite market volatility. Around 35 per cent of respondents said they increased their SIP allocations over the past year, while another 38 per cent maintained their existing investments.

However, Bernstein cautioned that investor patience may not be unlimited during prolonged periods of weak returns. Nearly one in three respondents said they would

wait only another 3 to 12 months before reassessing their SIP allocations if market performance remains lacklustre. Another 17 per cent said they could wait up to two years before reconsidering allocations.

The report added that about 38 per cent of respondents claimed they would continue SIP investments even if markets fail to generate returns over the next three years. Bernstein, however, noted that actual investor behaviour during periods of sustained underperformance could differ from stated intentions.

It also highlighted that investors in regular MF plans appeared more resilient compared to direct-plan investors. Bernstein said direct-plan investors showed greater sensitivity to returns, indicating that MFs with higher dependence on direct-plan flows may witness more volatility during weaker market phases.

NLC India OFS subscribed 5 times by institutional buyers

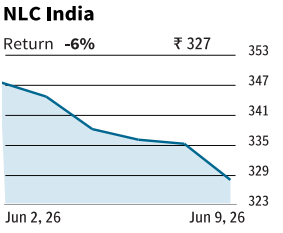
Press Trust of India

New Delhi

The government's offer-for-sale (OFS) of up to 3 per cent stake in NLC India got over-subscribed on the first day of the share sale with non-retail investors putting in bids worth ₹4,158 crore.

On Tuesday, non-retail investors bid for over 13.03 crore shares at an indicative price of ₹319.06 a share, as against the base offer size of 2.49 crore shares for them.

The government is selling about 4.16 crore shares, or up to 3 per cent stake, in NLC India, at a floor price of ₹303/share through a two-day OFS. The issue will open



for retail investors on Wednesday.

The stake sale comprises a base offer size of 2 per cent, and an additional 1 per cent green-shoe option in case of over-subscription.

Shares of NLC India closed at ₹327.85, down 2.32 per cent on the BSE. The government currently holds 72.20 per cent in NLC India.

Hexagon Nutrition IPO subscribed 53.68 times, NIIs lead demand

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Hexagon Nutrition's initial public offering (IPO) received strong investor demand on the final day of bidding, with the issue subscribed 53.68 times overall, driven largely by robust participation from non-institutional investors.

The non-institutional investors portion was subscribed 161.49 times, while the retail category saw subscription of 26.85 times and qualified institutional buyers segment booked 19.77 times. The ₹139-crore IPO came

Aggressive bids

	Number of times
QIBs	19.77
Non-institutions	161.49
Retail investors	26.85
Total	53.68

out with a price band of ₹42-45 a share. The public issue was entirely an offer-for-sale of over 3.08 crore shares by the promoters. At the upper end of the price band, the issue size is estimated at ₹138.87 crore.

ANCHOR PORTION

Ahead of the IPO opening, Hexagon Nutrition raised ₹41.66 crore from anchor in-

vestors by allotting 92.57 lakh shares at ₹45 apiece.

Bandhan Small Cap Fund was the only domestic mutual fund participant in the anchor book, receiving an allocation of 26.66 lakh shares worth ₹12 crore. Other investors included Ampersand Growth Opportunities Fund Scheme-I, CP Capital Ltd, Visionary Value Fund and Inovative Vision Fund.

Hexagon Nutrition said the proposed listing would help enhance visibility, strengthen brand recognition and provide liquidity to existing shareholders. Shares of the company are expected to list on June 12.

Adani Green Energy promoter sells 1.3% stake for ₹3,246 crore

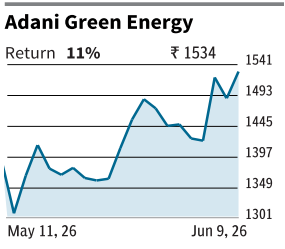
Press Trust of India

New Delhi

A promoter group entity of Adani Green Energy on Tuesday sold a 1.3 per cent stake to Adani Infra (India) Ltd for ₹3,246 crore through open market transactions.

According to the block deal data on the NSE, Ardour Investment Holding Ltd, a promoter entity, offloaded 2.15 crore shares, representing a 1.3 per cent stake in Adani Green Energy.

The shares were disposed of at an average price of ₹1,510, taking the transaction value to ₹3,246.50 crore. At the end of the March



quarter, Ardour Investment Holding Ltd owned a 6.35 per cent equity stake in the company. Meanwhile, Adani Infra (India) Ltd acquired the same number of shares, per the data.

Shares of Adani Green Energy rose nearly 3 per cent to close at ₹1,532 apiece on the NSE.

JioBlackRock not chasing lowest-cost tag, says CEO

Aishwarya Kumar

Bengaluru

For many investors, JioBlackRock's entry into the mutual fund industry carried echoes of Reliance Jio's disruption of the telecom market. Expectations of ultra low fees and aggressive pricing followed naturally.

A year later, however, the fund house is drawing a different line in the sand. "We're not trying to be the cheapest," said Sid Swaminathan, MD & CEO, JioBlackRock AMC, arguing that value and performance matter more than headline costs. Instead, the company evaluates pricing based on the returns and alpha a strategy can generate, while using technology and scale to improve efficiency where possible.

"We think about pricing more in terms of the value-for-money concept rather than just the headline that this has to be the cheapest,"



Sid Swaminathan, MD & CEO, JioBlackRock AMC

Swaminathan said. JioBlackRock aims to become one of India's largest fund houses within five years as it expands its product suite and distribution network, betting on emerging investment categories such as special-ised investment funds (SIFs) to drive the next phase of growth.

The joint venture between Jio Financial Services and BlackRock has amassed nearly ₹19,000 crore in assets under management and attracted 11.5 lakh investors within a year of launching its first funds, according to Swaminathan. "In five years'

time, we want to be one of the largest players here."

The asset manager is now preparing to launch its first hybrid long-short SIF on June 29 and will simultaneously enter physical distribution, marking a shift from its initial direct-to-consumer, digital-first strategy.

The AMC currently operates 14 MF schemes and has seen strong traction from retail investors. Its flagship Flexi Cap Fund has crossed ₹3,000 crore in assets and attracted more than seven lakh investors.

Swaminathan said 20 per cent of JioBlackRock's investor base comprises first-time mutual fund investors, while 40 per cent of its retail AUM originates from beyond the top 30 cities.

"We see the potential for this market to be two to three times where it is today over the next five years," he said, citing India's favourable demographics, rising participation and growing financialisation of savings.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

INTERGLOBE AVIATION (BUY)

Target: ₹5,200
CMP: ₹4,537.60

InterGlobe Aviation (IndiGo)'s management announced aggressive targets for FY30 at its CY26 Analyst Day — about 300 billion capacity (ASK), >550 aircraft fleet, about 200 million passengers, and about 3,000 daily flights, with mid-teens FY28-30E ASK CAGR. Narrow bodies are expected to be IndiGo's core, but new configurations will be introduced. However, the FY27 outlook is volatile and the management has guided for a broad single-digit growth in ASK year on year amid capacity rationalisation (variable cost is not met), with passenger range-bound (about 125 million). Pricing, however, would drive earnings growth, as seen in other consumption industries. Normalisation of the West Asia sector is crucial for driving the international segment, and status of the conflict is a primary near-term determinant.

Indigo is also optimistic about the launch of XLRs (delivered two of the nine annual target), and upgrade of features with regard to meals and seats for making long-haul flights and Stretch more attractive. The government of India's fuel pricing support is a positive, but more reforms are required for the industry to sustain during adverse cycles. Indigo is evaluating fuel hedging for international flights (as do competitors in Europe and Asia). We lower FY27E ARPU growth from 8 per cent to 6 per cent, but increase the yield accordingly, thus retaining our earnings estimate and TP of ₹5,200; BUY.

Yes Securities

SAMVARDHANA MOTHERSON (BUY)

Target: ₹163
CMP: ₹144.15

We reiterate Buy on Samvardhana Motherson (SAMIL) with revised TP of ₹163 (25x March 2028 EPS). SAMIL's recent stock outperformance, despite a volatile global macro backdrop, is led by resilient FY26 marked by improved booked business at about \$96 billion (vs \$87.2 billion in September 2025, \$88.1 billion in March 2025).

The outlook remains robust, supported by new programme ramp-up, greenfield additions and accelerating non-auto contributions.

Non-auto segments, especially consumer electronics (CE) – EBITDA positive in Q4 with business already have achieved projected annual capacity from two plants and upcoming mega new plant (GF3) in Q3FY27 to have upstream capabilities leading to further margin expansion. Aerospace revenues grew about 40 per cent year on year in FY26 at ₹2,460 crore (vs ₹1,750 crore in FY25) with EBITDA margins at 8.3 per cent (vs 7.3 per cent) with OB at about \$1.6 billion (vs \$1.2 billion earlier).

Diversification across high-growth emerging markets (now >50 per cent of revenues) adds resilience, while core businesses across wiring harnesses, vision systems, and modules/polymers retain meaningful white-space. We expect growth to sustain in FY27 as key levers such as scale-up non-auto, deeper integration into Japanese OEMs payout. We build revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of 9.5-14 per cent with the stock trading at 25.5x/21.7x FY27/FY28 consolidated EPS.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Federal Bank (₹315.15): BUY

Gurumurthy K

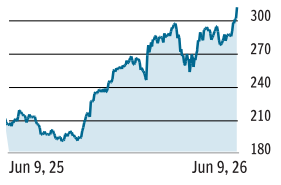
bl_research_bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Federal Bank. The price action since March indicates a cup and handle pattern on the daily chart. The strong rise above ₹302 this week confirms this pattern. That in turn strengthens the bullish case. The region between ₹305 and ₹300 will be a very good support zone now. Intermediate dips are likely to get fresh buyers above this support region and limit the downside.

Federal Bank share price can rise to ₹350 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Federal Bank shares now at ₹315. Accumulate on dips at ₹307.

Federal Bank

Return 48% ₹ 315



Keep the stop-loss at ₹294. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹319 when the price goes up to ₹325. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹326 and ₹333 when the price touches ₹330 and ₹340, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹345.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
23347	23300	23140	23470	23600	Go long now and at 23310. Stop-loss can be kept at 23270
HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹740	736	732	743	747	Take longs only above 743. Keep the stop-loss at 742
Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹1182	1160	1145	1195	1210	Go long only above 1195. Keep the stop-loss at 1190
ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹280	277	275	281	284	Go long only above 281. Stop-loss can be kept at 280
ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹259	257	253	262	265	Wait for a rise. Go short at 261 with a stop-loss at 263
Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹1272	1255	1230	1285	1300	Wait for a rise. Go short at 1280 with a stop-loss at 1290
SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹1004	995	985	1025	1040	Go long now and at 998. Keep the stop-loss at 990
TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
₹2151	2135	2110	2175	2220	Go short if TCS turns down from 2175. Keep the stop-loss at 2185

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers

	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
ICICI Bank	1275.00	38.69	15.75	8.56
State Bank	1002.70	18.79	10.68	3.91
Axis Bank	1292.40	15.21	15.13	3.48
Bajaj Finance	886.30	9.23	28.55	2.23
Int'lGlobeVhi	4537.60	8.78	0.00	0.96
Reliance Ind.	1269.20	8.70	17.94	8.05
Kotak Bank	381.70	7.39	19.68	2.64
L&T	3900.60	6.43	28.31	4.30
Maruti Suzuki	13120.00	5.96	28.10	1.62
Asian Paints	2708.10	4.82	59.11	1.15
M&M	2990.10	4.70	19.97	2.51
Shriram Finance Ltd.	911.70	4.60	21.40	1.20
Eicher Motors Ltd.	7203.00	4.59	35.83	0.93
Hindalco	1076.70	4.52	18.07	1.46
Hind Unilever	2132.80	4.40	47.36	1.78
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	234.21	3.83	95.33	0.72
Grossm Ind.	3095.50	3.77	20.45	1.11
Apollo Hosp	8524.00	3.72	61.20	0.82
Adani Ports	1826.40	3.44	32.92	1.26
Trent Ltd.	2771.30	3.43	85.85	0.87
UltraTech Cement	10911.00	3.00	39.27	1.21
Bajaj Finserv	1693.10	2.33	13.78	0.92
NestleIndia	1410.40	1.80	71.73	0.95
ITC	280.00	1.16	16.69	2.53
Coal India	466.90	0.99	9.26	1.00
Tata Steel	203.18	0.83	23.30	1.58
Adani Enter	2979.90	0.62	38.69	0.80
SBI Life	1769.10	0.46	71.83	0.75
JSW Steel	1261.70	0.20	12.10	1.11
Wipro	181.67	0.06	14.36	0.49
TataConsumerProduct	1106.50	-0.07	70.79	0.68
TCS	2151.00	-0.09	15.74	2.06
Tata Motors PV	387.80	-0.55	4760.41	0.76
Bharat Elec	412.05	-0.70	49.68	1.39
Max Healthcare	10603.10	-0.71	67.68	0.70
HDFC Life	650.68	-0.93	63.25	0.57
Dr Reddys Lab	1268.50	-0.94	25.47	0.73
HDFC Bank	738.35	-1.00	14.35	1.01
Bajaj Auto	10184.00	-1.14	26.92	1.66
HCL Tech	1146.30	-1.15	18.68	1.14
Cipla	1376.50	-1.40	28.79	0.73
Sun Pharma	1779.90	-2.26	37.09	1.77
Tech Mahindra	1483.90	-2.72	30.25	0.88
Eternal Ltd.	245.65	-4.17	647.71	1.66
PowerGrid Corp	285.70	-4.55	16.68	1.21
ONGC	259.00	-4.79	6.54	0.94
Infosys	1180.30	-5.58	16.24	3.88
NTPC	355.65	-6.98	12.52	1.58
Titan	4104.90	-7.82	71.82	1.50
Bharti Airtel	1799.00	-9.58	32.41	5.18

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Divis Lab	6753.00	83.32	69.81	3.47
Bank of Baroda	273.75	76.02	7.05	2.05
Samvardhamothersoninternat	144.06	63.16	37.22	2.58
Canara Bank	53.36	6.98	6.98	1.87
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1495.40	47.68	24.34	2.59
Bajaj Holdings	10253.00	47.10	11.66	1.79
Adanigreenenergy	1534.50	41.69	127.21	2.08
Punjab Natl Bank	109.65	38.39	6.82	1.53
Indian Hotels Co.	666.70	35.86	42.23	2.37
Rural Elec	352.10	30.71	5.69	1.78
Bosch	37820.00	29.66	40.22	1.33
Power Finance	435.60	29.63	42.8	1.36
Vardhagreenenergy	530.75	29.39	55.8	2.93
Hdfc Aem	2503.30	28.96	37.52	2.06
Union Bank	170.44	28.72	6.70	1.33
Tyts Motor Cpl	3358.00	26.81	50.07	1.19
Indian Oilcorp	138.13	26.71	4.47	2.09
Difl	575.15	25.11	32.25	1.49
Bpd	289.10	22.62	4.48	2.37
Pidilindt	1481.80	19.28	61.04	1.86
Torrent Pharma	4472.90	18.47	70.81	1.89
Gordex Consumer	1103.20	18.42	55.70	1.65
United Spirits	1257.20	15.61	48.98	1.50
Cg Power & Ind Sol	91.12	15.12	119.92	2.53
Industrialaeronautics	4263.80	13.83	31.28	3.27
Abn Developers	133.30	13.33	21.71	1.11
Zydlusfinance	110.65	12.62	23.75	1.22
Tata Capital	32.85	12.57	28.02	0.56
Avenuecorp	4092.00	11.94	89.66	2.43
Siemens Energy India .	354.12	11.62	96.45	1.27
Solar Industries	18267.00	10.53	95.18	1.80
Mazagon Dock	9.94	9.94	35.65	0.75
Britannia	5107.50	9.66	84.43	2.43
Vedanta	306.25	9.60	7.55	1.10
Hindus Zinc	563.65	9.37	17.22	0.99
Adani Energy Solutions .	1579.20	8.63	79.28	2.21
Muthootfin	2991.10	8.00	11.32	1.30
Indian Railway Finance Corp	96.01	7.45	11.90	0.78
Limnindia	3999.00	5.94	12.93	1.50
Cummins India	5625.50	5.73	66.03	3.07
Adani Power	226.14	3.39	33.62	3.78
Tyts Motors Cv	363.30	1.77	44.18	3.07
Hydrali Motor India .	1898.60	1.52	28.40	1.09
Ambuga Cements	416.00	1.21	18.71	1.03
Amul	-1.65	1.08	10.80	1.29
Abn	8931.00	0.40	92.97	1.47
Shree Cement	23415.00	-4.54	48.31	1.27
Jindal Steel	1149.00	-6.70	34.90	1.72
Gail (India)	167.59	-7.70	14.53	1.83
Tata Power	38.26	-26.26	24.89	2.70

QUICKLY.

Infosys defers hiring over impersonation claims



New Delhi: IT services major Infosys has deferred online hiring examinations and in-person evaluations for the roles of specialist programmer and digital systems engineer, the company said in a statement on Tuesday. The statement comes in response to reports that the IT major paused assessments after detecting multiple instances of impersonation and candidate malpractice during the evaluation process. Infosys said all affected candidates had been informed about the postponement. **PTI**

GSK agrees to acquire Nuvalent for \$10.6 billion

GSK agreed to buy Nuvalent for \$10.6 billion, securing a US biotech firm developing treatments for lung cancer as part of the British pharmaceutical company's effort to rebuild its oncology franchise. GSK will pay \$124 a share in cash for Nuvalent, according to a statement on Tuesday, a 40 per cent premium over the Cambridge, Massachusetts-based company's closing share price on Monday. **BLOOMBERG**

IT firms bet on GCC boom with build-operate-transfer model

BIZ FACILITATION. The move aims to support multinational clients in establishing and scaling their operations

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

As India's GCC boom gathers pace, IT services companies are embracing the build-operate-transfer (BOT) model to create new revenue streams, helping multinational clients set up and scale captive centres even as such centres compete with traditional outsourcing businesses.

TCS's new GVIC business unit reflects the growing focus of Indian IT firms on helping enterprises establish and transform GCCs.

In 2025, Citizens Financial Group Inc, a US-based premier financial institution, announced a joint initiative with Cognizant to launch a GCC in Hyderabad. As citizens' strategic partner, Cognizant will build and operate the GCC.

Under the BOT approach, service providers build and run a GCC for a multinational client, helping it scale operations before eventually transferring the centre to the client's ownership.

STRATEGIC SHIFT
Akshay Mathur, Partner, Everest Group, emphasised that IT services firms are responding to a clear shift in

enterprise sourcing preferences.

"Many organisations view GCCs as a strategic operating model, not just as an alternative to outsourcing. Enterprises want greater ownership and control over critical technology, product engineering, AI, data, and other areas. Service providers are therefore positioning themselves as GCC partners to help design, build, scale and transform these centres," he said.

While GCC-related revenue is still a small share of most providers' books today, the growth rate and strategic significance of these mandates make them hard to ignore.

"It is important to focus on this sector as traditional IT services are going through a metamorphosis. The autonomous business will change the way IT services are delivered," said DD Mishra, VP Analyst, Gartner. Mathur explained that GCC practices are becoming a defensive and offensive play at the same time.

Defensively, they help providers participate in spending that might otherwise move away from traditional outsourcing models.

Offensively, they create new revenue streams across



SOURCING PIVOT. Experts emphasise that IT services firms are responding to a clear shift in enterprise sourcing preferences

advisory, setup, operate, talent acquisition, transformation and managed services.

LIMITED UPSIDE

However, he noted that while BOT deals could generate meaningful revenue, their margins were generally lower than those of large, long-term outsourcing contracts.

Mishra highlighted that traditional IT outsourcing thrives on multi-year, predictable recurring revenue.

"Under the BOT model, the internalisation phase represents a hard end to that income. During the 'operate' phase, the tech talent is legally employed by the IT services firm. During the 'transfer' phase, these engineers, data architects, and project managers officially cross over to the client's payroll," he said.

The model becomes more attractive when providers retain post-transfer work, such as managed services, consulting, platform support, or transformation projects. Without such follow-on engagements, a BOT arrangement may offer adequate returns but limited long-term economic upside.

Moreover, the growth of GCCs can cannibalise traditional outsourcing revenue streams, depending on the provider.

HIGH-MARGIN

Today, enterprises route high-margin, transformative digital projects directly to their own GCCs.

Traditional vendors are left out of the loop, losing the most lucrative portion of enterprise technology spend.

While enterprises are not completely cutting off tradi-

tional IT vendors, they are changing what they buy from them.

GCCs keep the strategic, high-value work — AI modeling, cloud architecture, data science — in-house.

Traditional IT service providers are losing their top-performing developers and domain experts to GCCs, which typically offer 20 per cent to 40 per cent higher compensation.

STRONG MOMENTUM

However, India has over 2,100 GCCs today, with strong momentum in new centre setup and expansion of existing centres.

Everest Group estimates that the service provider opportunity linked to GCCs is already upwards of \$25 billion in 2026 across offshore and nearshore geographies, growing at about 25 per cent year on year.

For large IT services firms that have invested in this space, GCC-related revenue is already meaningful, and in some cases, among their fastest-growing lines of business.

Mathur noted, "We have barely scratched the surface of GCC penetration, particularly in the mid-market segment, which gives this opportunity a long runway."

JSW Infra emerges as top bidder for Kolkata Port container berths

Our Bureau
Mumbai



The project is expected to create a total capacity of about 0.93 million TEUs

JSW Infrastructure has received a letter of award from the Syama Prasad Mookherjee Port Authority, pursuant to a competitive bidding process, for the integrated development of the outer container terminal, which consist of two berths and five berths at Netaji Subhas Dock (NSD) at the Kolkata Dock System.

The project was awarded on a design, build, finance, operate and transfer basis under the Public-Private Partnership framework and is aimed at enhancing container handling capacity, improving operational efficiency, and supporting growing trade volumes in the region.

Under the concession agreement with a 30 year tenure, the project will be executed in two phases and is expected to create a total capacity of approximately 0.93 million TEUs. The new award builds on the company's earlier LOA for the reconstruction of berth eight and mechanisation of berths seven and eight at NSD, Kolkata (0.45 million TEUs), with interim operations expected to commence shortly.

Together, these two projects expand the company's footprint at one of India's

key eastern gateway ports and reinforce its strategic presence in the Kolkata Dock System.

Upon completion, including the capacity from the ongoing berth seven and eight project, the company's combined container handling capacity at the Kolkata Dock System is expected to scale up to about 1.4 million TEUs.

Both the projects are expected to address existing capacity constraints at NSD, improve berth productivity through mechanisation and enhance vessel turnaround times. Upon completion of the identified container growth projects, the company's overall container handling capacity is expected to increase to about 1.8 million TEUs. The addition of incremental container capacity is aligned with the company's strategy to progressively scale up its third-party cargo business.

IN-SPACE seeks partners for ISRO rocket tech transfer

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

In a significant development, private players can now take up production of India's largest rocket.

In a move that will help Indian companies develop capabilities in heavy-lift launch vehicle production, space industry body Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre (IN-SPACe) has invited expressions of interest (EoI) from the private sector for transfer of technology (ToT) of ISRO's Launch Vehicle Mark-3 (LVM3).

The move is significant as it comes on the heels of a similar EoI issued for technology transfer of PSLV last month, and it points to a strategy to let ISRO focus its efforts on advanced R&D and critical programmes, such as Gaganyaan and other interplanetary missions, while private sector players take a larger role in operational and



PRIVATE PUSH. Space industry trackers call it a positive step

commercial space activities.

With this, most of India's key rocket systems are now open for commercialisation.

The EoI, which was released on Tuesday, invites eligible Indian private companies or industry consortia

to acquire and operationalise LVM3 technology from ISRO.

The LVM3, often referred to as ISRO's *Baahubali* rocket, is the agency's heaviest operational launch vehicle and is behind key

missions, including Chandrayaan 2 and Chandrayaan 3.

The selected private entity will receive technology transfer and extensive support from ISRO to absorb the technology and begin manufacturing and launching LVM3 vehicles commercially. The EoI invitation also lays down the eligibility criteria for the applicable private entities.

ISRO's handholding and infrastructure support is proposed for a defined period of 42 months or until the realisation and launch of two LVM3 vehicles by the selected entity, whichever comes earlier.

"Taking cognisance of the expanding global space economy and the strategic need to significantly scale up launch frequencies, IN-SPACe has taken the initiative for technology-transfer of LVM3 for end-to-end realisation, operation and commercialisation of launch vehicle by a suitable private

industry," IN-SPACe's note read.

LAUNCH FREQUENCY

Space industry trackers call it a positive step for the sector, though a bit late. A few incidents involving PSLV in the recent past may have prompted the government to consider technology transfer, they add.

"We already have various private sector infrastructure and aerospace companies who play a role in making the rockets; now with a technology transfer to such players, it will help improve the launch cadence which has been declining," Chaitanya Giri, Space Fellow at ORF, said. Another space industry executive said the speed of tech transfer, frequency of launches and the cost involved will likely determine the success of the model.

"The good part is that once the private sector kicks in, the number of launches may increase," the person added.

AGNIT Semicon opens ₹3 cr GaN testing, qualification lab at IISc

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

AGNIT Semiconductors, an indigenous Gallium Nitride (GaN) semiconductor start-up, has officially opened a new 350-square-foot advanced testing laboratory at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) in Bengaluru.

Financed through a ₹3 crore investment, the facility is designed to enhance do-

mestic semiconductor testing and validation infrastructure, specifically tailored for high-power radio-frequency (RF) applications.

QUALITY ASSURANCE

The setup aims to achieve rapid in-house validation, reduce external dependency, enhance customer confidence in quality assurance and strengthen market readiness across defence, telecom and next-generation RF sectors.

HC decision eases interest pressure for telcos: Experts

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Bombay High Court's decision to quash one-time spectrum charges for telcos is materially positive on an accounting level, particularly with the dismissal of the 16 per cent compound interest that escalated principal charges, as per analysts.

Industry experts have called the judgment a positive decision especially for debt-ridden Vodafone Idea (Vi) that can use the judgment for its other spectrum cases pending in the Supreme Court.

However, the dismissal of the interest along with one-time charges eases a severe ramp-up of the principal amount, as per telecom expert Parag Kar.

"If Airtel's original amount of ₹8,414 crore is escalated by 16 per cent for 12 years, the outstanding amount as of March 2026 would be around ₹50,000 crore," said Kar, stressing the importance of the judgment.

NO MATERIAL IMPACT

On a case-to-case basis, Bharti Airtel's potential writback of ₹11,760 crore is unlikely to have any significant cash flow impact, said



Industry experts have called the judgment a positive decision especially for debt-ridden Vodafone Idea

Morgan Stanley in its research note.

However, the judgment improves visibility and eliminates potential cash outflow risk.

CASH FLOW

"Partial provisioning was already taken, so there could be a reversal, potentially an exceptional item. However, this may not have any cash flow implications. This is a positive for sentiment, though the ruling could be challenged in the highest

court," said the research note. Following the judgment, Airtel issued a statement detailing the plea's arguments against a 2013 demand notice amounting to a revised amount of ₹8,414 crore in 2018, issued by the Department of Telecommunications.

CHANGING TIDES

Meanwhile, Nomura estimated that the potential reversal of ₹7,580 crore for Vi is more meaningful considering the telco's negative net worth of ₹35,760 crore as of FY26 end and cash flow challenges.

Spectrum charges relief is a small part of Vi's total liabilities which are dominated by large AGR and spectrum liabilities.

Vi also carries a contingent liability of ₹3,350 crore on its books.

"The situation is slightly complicated for Vodafone Idea as the provisioned amount includes OTSC pertaining to both former Idea and Vodafone before the merger.

The judgment provides a relief to only the erstwhile Idea's portion of OTSC liability, while former Vodafone's OTSC liability hearing is currently pending in the Supreme Court," said Nomura in its research note.

AI will sunset certain job roles, create some others: Arundhati Bhattacharya

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Arundhati Bhattacharya, President and CEO, Salesforce – South Asia, said that certain types of jobs will sunset due to artificial intelligence (AI). However, it will create new roles not in vogue. Stating that India occupied a key role in the company's global operations, she said that the talent pool here was very deep.

"It enables you to get any kind of talent that you really want. There is a choice regarding who you want to get because there will be quite a bit of competition for it," she said.

Bhattacharya was in the city to mark the 10th anniversary of its Centre of Excellence.

"There is a cost leverage as well. Because if you compare with some developed countries, I think India compares quite favourably. The cost would not make any difference if the delivery quality were poor. It's also the quality of the delivery that makes people believe that this is a good place to be," she said.

Asked about how AI is impacting the industry overall and Salesforce, in particular, she said "the kinds of roles now being envisaged were very different from what we thought two years back".

JOB ROLES

"We were not talking about job roles such as forward-deployed engineers, content creators and agent orchestrators. Some towards tutor-



ARUNDHATI BHATTACHARYA
President and CEO, Salesforce – South Asia

Certain repetitive jobs will disappear because AI does them better, faster and error-free

ing the agents themselves. As we go forward, more and more such roles will be created because the requirements will differ significantly," she said.

"It is essential that we keep ourselves upskilled so that, as those roles come up, we are able to take them on. There will be some sunseting on certain skills, some skills that will be more in demand, some new skills that will come up that we will need to then internalise, and that is the way this whole thing is going to happen,"

she said. "The only way that you can allay these fears is if you lean into AI. You will not be able to allay those fears because it's a fact: certain repetitive jobs will disappear because AI does them better, faster, and error-free."

AI SKILLING

To mark 10 years of its Centre of Excellence, Salesforce, a customer relationship management technology company, announced a programme to equip one million learners across the country with AI-related skills by 2030.

'Leveraging Trailhead', the free digital learning ecosystem, will be offered through collaborations with academic institutions, industry leaders and government agencies. The company will offer a virtual internship with the All India Council for Technical Education, providing students with hands-on project experience and job-ready Salesforce and AI skills. It has tied up with Manipal Academy of Higher Education, Accenture, Deloitte, Grant Thornton Bharat, Infosys, PwC and TCS for structured training curricula and mentorship-led learning.

TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)

The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 3rd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The **Tata Power Company Limited** invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai.

(A) Supply of Transformer Oil for Tata Power at various Transmission divisions in Mumbai region. (**Package Ref: CC27PRD003**).

Interested and eligible bidders to submit Tender Fee and Authorization Letter before **1500 hrs. Tuesday, 16th June 2026**.

For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website **https://www.tatapower.com**. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender will be published on Tender section of above website (**Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents**) only.

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The **Tata Power Company Limited** invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender packages (Two-part Bidding).

(A) Following is Corrigendum 2 to Original Tender published on 09 May 2026 and Corrigendum 1 published on 29 May 2026.

Original Tender Name - Supply of Tower Steel for Mumbai Transmission (**Package Ref No: CC27FK003**).

Updated Tender Name - Supply of Tower Steel for Various Transmission Project (**Package Ref No: CC27FK003**).

Interested & eligible bidders to submit Tender Fee & Authorization Letter before **1500 Hrs. Monday, 15th June 2026**.

For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website **https://www.tatapower.com**. Also, all future corrigendum's/addendum's if any, to the said tenders will be published on Tender section of above website (**Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents**) only.

QUICKLY.

Precious metals up as dollar weakens



Gold edged higher on Tuesday as a weaker dollar lent support. Spot gold edged 0.2 per cent higher at \$4,338.69 per ounce, as of 1305 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery were steady at \$4,363.90. Silver rose 0.7 per cent to \$68.61, platinum gained 1.4 per cent to \$1,778.98, and palladium rose 3.8 per cent to \$1,251.05. REUTERS

Copper rises as dollar dips, LME stocks tighten

London: Copper prices climbed as the dollar weakened after Israel and Iran agreed to halt attacks on each other, while visible metal inventories outside the US tightened further. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME rose 0.9 per cent to \$13,740 a tonne. The available stocks in LME registered warehouses were at 2,28,650 tonnes, the lowest since February 19. REUTERS

Crude oil falls as Iran and Israel halt attacks



Singapore: Crude oil prices fell after Iran and Israel said they had halted attacks on each other following an appeal from US President Donald Trump. Brent crude futures were down \$1.14 at \$93.11 a barrel at 0630 GMT, while US West Texas Intermediate declined \$1.3 at \$90 a barrel. REUTERS

Monsoon gets positive IOD boost as El Nino threat looms

AT THE DOORS. Sea surface temperatures crossed the El Nino threshold on June 7, while the IOD may turn positive during August-September

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

Sea surface temperatures (SSTs) crossed the drought-bearing El Nino threshold of +0.80°C as of June 7, while the Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) could turn positive during August-September, boosting the prospects of the South-West monsoon, Australia's Bureau of Meteorology (BoM) has said.

The recent relative Nino 3.4 index value, which measures the sea surface temperature (SST) anomalies in the central-to-eastern equatorial Pacific, for the week ending June 7, is +0.81°C; this is just above the El Nino threshold (+0.80°C), BoM said in its *Southern Hemisphere Monitoring Report*.

All models, including that

of the Bureau's, indicate the tropical Pacific will continue to warm over the coming months.

On the other hand, the IOD is currently neutral. As of June 7, the IOD index was -0.34°C. Forecasts are still uncertain, but most models suggest neutral conditions will continue at least through June and August, with the possibility of a positive IOD event developing in August-September, said the Australian weather agency.

IOD POSITIVE IMPACT

A positive IOD can bring more moisture to India, often helping monsoon rain even in an El Nino year.

IOD is a climate phenomenon caused by variations in sea temperatures in the Indian Ocean. Its positive,



DECIDING FACTOR. How the monsoon unfolds this season may depend on the balance between Pacific warming and weather patterns developing in the Indian Ocean

negative and neutral phases can influence the Indian monsoon.

The development comes on the heels of the India Meteorological Department (IMD) lowering its forecast for the South-West Monsoon to 90 per cent of the long-period average rainfall. The

monsoon, which set in three days late on June 4, is currently 18 per cent deficient.

Months of warming have brought the tropical Pacific one step closer to El Nino conditions. Weakening trade winds and the falling pressure patterns suggest that the atmosphere is beginning to catch up, said the BoM.

UNCERTAINTY

If these trends persist, an El Nino event is likely in the coming months, with forecasts indicating further warming over the tropical Pacific. All models, including the Bureau's, indicate that the tropical Pacific will continue to warm over the coming months.

The report said there was still some uncertainty about the strength of this El Nino. Global models suggest that it

will be at least of moderate strength with the possibility of a strong event depending on how much warming occurs in the central tropical Pacific.

A strong El Nino signal in the Nino3.4 region does not necessarily translate into a strong impact, as ENSO is only one of many factors that can influence seasonal weather and climate.

ATMOSPHERIC SHIFT

As of June 7, the 30-day Southern Oscillation Index (SOI) is -21.7. The SOI index values at days 60 and 90 are -14.9 and -9.5, respectively.

The Southern Oscillation Index (SOI) is a measure of the strength of ENSO (El Nino-Southern Oscillation) based on the differences in air pressure between Tahiti and Darwin, Australia.

Trade winds are weaker than normal across the tropical Pacific, but there has been no persistent change in the pattern of cloudiness near the date line.

Collectively, these indicators suggest that the atmosphere is starting to respond to the SST signal in the tropical Pacific and is showing early stages of the ocean-atmosphere coupling needed for an established event.

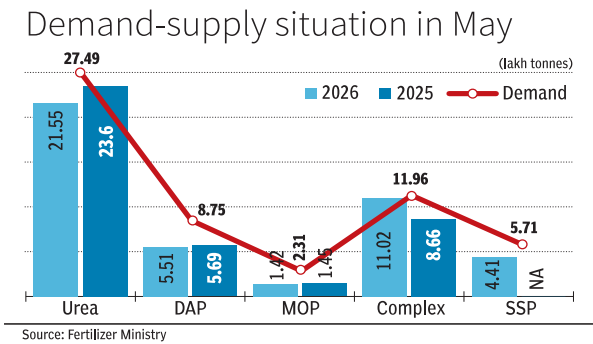
The SST analysis for the week ending June 7, shows average to above-average waters around most of Australia. Waters are particularly warm along the coasts of New South Wales and eastern Tasmania (up to around 3°C to 4°C above average). "This SST pattern will likely continue for the next several months," the report added.

Complex fertilizer sales up 27% in May, chops off savings from lower urea sales

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

After higher sales for two months since the US-Israel conflict against Iran began, India has been able to contain the consumption of major fertilizers, such as urea and di-ammonia phosphate (DAP), during May below the estimated demand for the month as well as from year-ago levels. Only in the case of complex fertilizer (combination of N, P, K nutrients) there was a 27 per cent rise in sales and it has contributed to the total sales of all four key fertilizers matching the year-ago number.

As reported by *businessline*, there was panic buying of fertilizers in March and April, leading to a huge surge



in sales. The Centre reached out to the States to ensure the sales were reduced.

Official sources said that overall consumption of urea, DAP, muriate of potash (MOP) and complex was 39.5 lakh tonnes (lt) in May against 39.4 lt a year ago.

Last month, sales of urea were 21.55 lt (23.6 lt), while those of DAP were 5.51 lt (5.69 lt) and MOP a tad lower at 1.42 lt (1.45 lt). But complex increased to 11.02 lt from 8.66 lt a year ago, and this offset the savings the government may have made from highly subsidised urea and DAP.

While the government has been able to maintain the re-

tail prices of urea and DAP, rates of popular NPK products (having 3 or 4 nutrients) increased by 16-41 per cent from a year ago.

MAJOR CONCERNS

With the overall sales for May, fertilizer consumption in the first two months of the current fiscal have reached 64 lt against 58.32 lt during the corresponding period of 2025-26 and 51.29 lt in the comparable period of 2024-25.

"Continuous over-reliance on chemical inputs affects soil biodiversity and microbial activity, reducing the natural fertility and long-term productive capacity of agricultural land," Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said in a communication to the States.

Higher oilseeds prices may prompt farmers to expand area

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Prices of key kharif oilseeds, such as groundnut and soybean, are ruling higher compared to levels a year ago at the start of the planting season. The trend will likely encourage farmers to expand the acreage across all key growing regions, say traders.

Prices of soybean have increased in recent months due to the tight demand-supply situation. As per Solvent Extractors Association of India data, the ex-mandi soybean prices as of June 5 stood at ₹68,000 per tonne in Indore, higher than the average of ₹43,396 a year ago. Soybean prices are currently ruling higher than the minimum support price (MSP)

of ₹5,708 per quintal announced by the government for the 2026-27 marketing season.

Similarly, groundnut prices were ruling higher at ₹72,000 per tonne as of June 5 in Saurashtra, higher than ₹53,720 a year ago.

However, groundnut prices are a tad lower than the MSP announced for 2026-27 at ₹7,517 per quintal. Sunflower price are ruling higher than around the ₹70,000 levels per tonne a year ago in Karnataka and Maharashtra, per SEA data.

RUSH FOR SEEDS

"The area under soybean will go up across all producing States, but it is too early to comment on the extent of increase," said DN Pathak, Executive Director of the Soybean Processors Association of India (SOPA). In Karnataka, where sowing has already started, there's a rush from farmers to buy seeds in districts like Haveri, according to reports.

In Gujarat, the largest producer, groundnut has been planted on about 55,788 hectares as of June 8 against 31,110 hectares a year ago, per the State Agriculture Department Data.

Sanjeev Asthana, President, SEA of India, in a recent letter to member of the trade body, said: "Sustained price realisations and improving market sentiment may also encourage farmers to expand oilseed acreage during the upcoming kharif season, supporting domestic production growth over the longer term."

Natural rubber prices soar to a record ₹267/kg on global cues, supply woes

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Riding on the strength of surging international rates, natural rubber prices in the domestic market have moved north, reaching an all-time high of ₹267 per kg. At the beginning of the year, the commodity was trading at ₹185 per kg.

Traders said there were reports of transactions in Kottayam at ₹269 per kg too. 2026 has witnessed a steady rise in rubber prices across major international markets. RSS-3 rubber prices in the Bangkok market, which stood at ₹191.85 at the start of the year, have now climbed to ₹304.62 per kg.

According to George Vally, President of the Indian Rubber Dealers Federation, the upward trend is driven by supply shortages caused by

rain, rising international prices, disruptions linked to the West Asia crisis and raw material shortages.

GROWERS ENTHUSED

The onset of the monsoon and persistent rainfall in major production centres have disrupted tapping operations, resulting in lower arrivals of rubber sheets. The quantities reaching the market are largely from stocks held by dealers and farmers.

Meanwhile, consuming industries continue to purchase rubber at prevailing prices to meet production requirements, he said.

Official sources said the current price levels could encourage growers to resume tapping in abandoned plantations, thereby improving the availability of raw materials in the market.

Major rubber-producing countries in South-East Asia



have also been affected by adverse weather conditions. Heavy rain, coupled with the annual wintering phase, have reduced tapping days and latex yields, leading to lower supplies and higher prices.

EV SEGMENT'S SUPPORT

Higher crude oil prices, driven by tensions in conflict-hit West Asia, have disrupted trade and logistics and pushed up the prices of synthetic rubber, a petroleum-based product.

As a result, manufacturers are increasingly shifting to

natural rubber, boosting demand and contributing to the price rise.

Robust demand from the automotive industry, including the rapidly expanding electric vehicle segment, has also supported the upward price trajectory.

Over the years, the gap between production and consumption has continued to widen, with consumption consistently exceeding production.

According to the latest statistical report of the Association of Natural Rubber Producing Countries (ANRPC), global natural rubber production is expected to increase by 2.2 per cent in 2026 to an estimated 15.32 million tonnes (mt).

However, consumption is projected to grow by 1.4 per cent to approximately 15.60 mt, indicating a continuing supply deficit.

Monsoon progress uneven; East gains, West slows

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The Arabian Sea arm of the monsoon hardly moved from Monday's coordinates of Harnai on the West Coast and Solapur, Kalaburagi, Nandyal and Chennai in the South Peninsula but the Bay of Bengal arm advanced rain into remaining parts of the North-Eastern States, entire Sikkim, and parts of hills of West Bengal on Tuesday.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said the Arabian Sea arm may not make significant progress on the West Coast on Wednesday either in view of an incoming intruder western disturbance, while it may advance into more parts of Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and the remaining parts of Tamil Nadu.

TO BE SUBDUED

To the east, the Bay of Bengal arm is expected to make fur-



WET WEATHER. Commuters make their way through rain-soaked streets in Shivamogga, Karnataka, on Tuesday as intermittent monsoon showers continued across the region SK DINESH

ther progress in West Bengal, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Jharkhand and Odisha during next 4-5 days, thanks to the strengthening flows.

The monsoon is likely to stay subdued over many parts of the West Coast, where it has been most active during the week after its delayed onset.

Mumbai received light rain in the evening while it was comparably heavier Konkan-Goa, coastal Karnataka and Kerala. Moderate to heavy rain was reported from elsewhere in the adjoining South Peninsula across north interior Karnataka, Telangana, Rayalaseema, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.

WESTERN DISTURBANCE

The incoming western disturbance will bring rain and thundershowers to the North-West and Central India as well.

According to the IMD, the intruder disturbance will affect the Himalayan region over next two days. A relatively weak successor is expected around Saturday and may persist until June 17.

As a result, the monsoon's progress is likely to remain sluggish during this period, especially along the West Coast.

Heavy rainfall on Wednesday is expected to be largely confined to the coastal belt from Panaji through Karwar and Bhatkal to Mangaluru and Kannur.

Thereafter, both the intensity and spatial extent of rainfall are likely to decrease progressively over the following days.

Forecasters are also monitoring signs of a circulation developing over the Bay of Bengal near the Andhra Pradesh-Odisha coast by June 22-23.

If it materialises, it could provide fresh momentum for the monsoon's advance into Central India.

Odisha farmers export Amrapali mangoes to London

A J Vinayak
Mangaluru

A self-help group (SHG) from Odisha's Angul district, Maa Kalijai SHG, has exported 7.5 quintals of Amrapali mangoes to London.

A media statement said that the success of the Maa Kalijai SHG was enabled through the support of the Directorate of Horticulture under the Department of Agriculture and Farmers' Empowerment, under the Promotion and Stabilisation of Farmer Producer Organisations (PSFPO) project.

GLOBAL MARKETS

Marketing facilitation for the export was supported by Palladium Consulting, which was also the implementation partner for the PSFPO pro-



REAPING SUCCESS. So far this year, Odisha has exported 90 tonnes of mangoes

ject. Mission Shakti and the Odisha Livelihoods Mission were instrumental in the overall strengthening of the SHG, contributing to its sustained development and enhanced capabilities, enabling the group to reach new heights and connect its products with global markets.

So far this year, Odisha has achieved 90 tonnes of mango

exports. Quoting Soumya Ranjan Sahoo, agribusiness expert, Palladium, the statement said: "This is a powerful demonstration of how targeted intervention, institutional convergence and capacity building can unlock the potential of even the smallest producer groups. This milestone sets a new benchmark for inclusive agri-exports in Odisha."

Retain longs in aluminium

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Aluminium futures (₹385/kg), after hitting a high of ₹397.10 on June 3, saw some moderation in price and are now hovering around ₹385, where the 21-day moving average lies.

COMMODITY CALL.

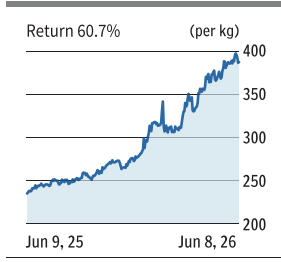
The June futures slipped to mark a low of ₹382.15 on Monday.

Thus, the long position that we had recommended marginally survived from the stop-loss at ₹382.

Despite the recent price correction, aluminium futures maintain the positive outlook since ₹382 is a support.

We expect the bulls to regain traction, and the contract can touch ₹400.

On the other hand, if alu-



minium futures breach the support at ₹382, the downside could extend to ₹375, its 50-day moving average.

A breakdown below this level could turn the outlook bearish. Nearest support below ₹375 is at ₹365.

That said, as it stands, we continue to hold a positive outlook.

TRADE STRATEGY

We had suggested buying aluminium futures at ₹386 a couple of weeks ago.

Retain this trade and maintain stop-loss at ₹382. Book profits at ₹400.

FSC tag to widen market access for smallholder bamboo farmers

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Industree Foundation has become the first organisation in India to secure Forest Stewardship Council (FSC) Forest Management Certification for privately owned bamboo plantations managed by smallholder farmers.

Awarded by SCS Global Services, the certification covers 6,671 small and marginal women farmers cultivating bamboo across 1,112.9 hectares in Karnataka's Shivamogga, Hassan and Chikkamagaluru districts. Many of the plantations are on fragmented and previously barren plots.

The achievement is significant because FSC certifications are typically awarded to large, consolidated forest estates. Industree brought

together hundreds of women farmers under a single certification framework, overcoming the challenges of fragmented landholdings, and setting a benchmark for community-level forest certification in India.

The FSC Group Certification framework enables smallholders to collectively meet certification requirements by sharing responsibilities under a common entity, reducing costs and administrative complexity.

OPENING DOORS

"For the women farmers and collectives who have worked hard to achieve this certification, it is recognition of their commitment and resilience. It also creates a visible pathway for thousands of smallholder farmers to access FSC certification and global mar-

kets," said Neju George Abraham, CEO, Industree Foundation.

The certification verifies that the bamboo is sustainably grown, legally compliant and fully traceable, meeting requirements of buyers in sectors such as fashion, furniture, packaging, construction and décor. Certified products can command a premium, helping farmers integrate into global supply chains and potentially earn an additional annual income of ₹1 lakh within 3-4 years, the foundation said.

Through its Regenerative Agroforestry and Livelihoods Project, Industree provides training on land assessment, species selection, soil preparation, planting, growth monitoring, sustainable harvesting and compliance with FSC standards.

QUICKLY.

OMCs increase aviation turbine fuel prices by 10%



Mumbai: State oil marketing companies have revised aviation turbine fuel prices for scheduled domestic operations by 10 per cent to around ₹115 per litre in Delhi. The move signals lifting of a 25 per cent cap on fuel sold to domestic airlines and follows the Union Cabinet's decision to introduce a ₹10,000 crore aviation turbine fuel price stabilisation fund to shield airlines. The scheme is optional for airlines and they would have to enter into a MoU with oil companies to avail. Oil companies would receive interest free advance from government for selling below cost. The government is yet to issue a notification or policy document regarding the stabilisation fund. An executive from an oil marketing company confirmed the price revision that came into effect from Tuesday. **OUR BUREAU**

Modified UDAN scheme aims to add 100 airports; launch on June 20

NEW ROUTES. The ₹28,840-crore programme to focus on underserved regions and helipads in the next decade

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Centre is set to launch the next phase of its regional aviation programme, with the modified UDAN scheme expected to be unveiled by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Kolkata on June 20. Accordingly, the modified Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS)-UDAN will be implemented over a 10-year period from FY27 to FY36 and is backed by a budgetary outlay of ₹28,840 crore aimed at expanding air connectivity to underserved and unserved regions across the country. In March 2026, the Union Cabinet approved the modified UDAN framework, which seeks to deepen regional connectivity while addressing several operational and infrastructure challenges encountered during earlier phases of the scheme. Notably, *businessline* was the first to report on the pro-

posed revamp of the UDAN scheme and its key contours ahead of Cabinet approval.

REGIONAL SUPPORT Under the approved structure, the scheme aims to connect 120 additional destinations and facilitate air travel for nearly four crore passengers over the next decade. A key feature of the programme is the development of 100 new airports from existing unserved airstrips through a challenge-based approach involving state governments. Moreover, projects will be prioritised based on factors such as state support, infrastructure readiness and regional development requirements. Besides, the scheme proposes operation and maintenance support for approximately 441 aerodromes to improve long-term sustainability of regional aviation infrastructure. The modified framework also includes the develop-



AFFORDABLE AVIATION. In March 2026, the Union Cabinet approved the modified UDAN framework, as it proposes to support 441 aerodromes across the country **MA SRIRAM**

ment of 200 modern helipads in hilly, remote, island and aspirational regions with an outlay of ₹3,661 crore, aimed at strengthening last-mile connectivity and emergency response capabilities. **REVISED FRAMEWORK** Furthermore, to improve the viability of regional routes, the scheme provides ₹10,043 crore towards viability gap funding (VGF) support for

airline operators over the next 10 years. Sources had earlier told *businessline* that the revised framework is expected to extend VGF support from the existing three-year period to five years, with a tapering structure designed to help airlines gradually transition routes towards commercial sustainability while keeping fares affordable for a longer duration. In addition, the scheme

incorporates support for indigenous aviation capacity through the proposed acquisition of two HAL Dhruv helicopters for Pawan Hans and two HAL Dornier aircraft for Alliance Air under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative. The revised framework also seeks to bring airport development and route development under a single umbrella, while addressing bottlenecks related to land acquisition, aircraft availability, leasing arrangements, maintenance support and regulatory approvals. Launched in 2016 under the National Civil Aviation Policy, UDAN was designed to make regional air travel affordable while expanding aviation access beyond major metropolitan centres. As of March 31, 2026, a total of 663 routes had been operationalised under the scheme. The programme has connected 95 aerodromes, including 17 heliports and two water aerodromes.



AP's hub-and-spoke flights set for June 25 launch

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Tata Group-promoted Air India will commence operations under the Centre's hub-and-spoke aviation model from June 25, with Varanasi becoming the first spoke city to be connected to the airline's international network through Delhi. Accordingly, the airline on Tuesday opened bookings for the new services, branded as 'Easy Connect' flights. These flights will allow passengers travelling from Varanasi to complete baggage check-in and international immigration formalities at their origin airport before connecting to overseas destinations via Delhi. Under the model, travellers originating from Varanasi will check in through to their final international destination and transit through Delhi as international passengers. **FIRST FLIGHT** As per the airline, the designated spoke-to-hub service, flight AI1111, will operate daily between Varanasi and Delhi, departing at 09.50 am

Under the model, passengers will complete baggage check-in and international travel formalities at their origin airport

and arriving at 11 am. Besides, the airline said that the service has been timed to provide onward connectivity within four hours to 18 international destinations from Delhi, including London Heathrow, Frankfurt, Rome, Milan, Zurich, Vienna, Copenhagen, Manila, Singapore, Phuket, Kuala Lumpur, Riyadh, Bangkok, Dubai, Colombo, Ho Chi Minh City and Kathmandu. Furthermore, future hub-and-spoke services from additional spoke cities will operate under the AI11XX flight series. Notably, *businessline* had reported last year that the Centre was examining a pilot project for seamless domestic-to-international travel under a hub-and-spoke framework, with Delhi and Varanasi emerging as the initial corridor under consideration.

US court strikes down H-1B fee, but uncertainty persists

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

A US federal court's decision to strike down the Donald Trump administration's \$100,000 fee on certain new H-1B visa applications may provide short-term relief to Indian IT services firms and other employers reliant on skilled foreign talent. However, experts caution that broader immigration scrutiny and hiring restrictions are likely to persist. A federal judge on Monday struck down the H-1B fee, ruling that it amounted to an unauthorised tax rather than

a lawful immigration penalty. The administration had argued the fee was permitted under the President's authority to restrict the entry of foreign nationals, but the court found that Congress had never authorised such a levy. The controversial \$100,000 H-1B fee was introduced by the Trump administration through a presidential proclamation in September 2025, marking a sharp departure from the traditional H-1B fee structure, which typically involved filing and processing charges amounting to a few thousand dollars per petition.



The one-time fee applied to certain new H-1B petitions and was intended to discourage reliance on lower-cost foreign labour while encouraging employers to hire higher-paid, highly-skilled workers. "The ruling gives Indian IT firms, multinational em-

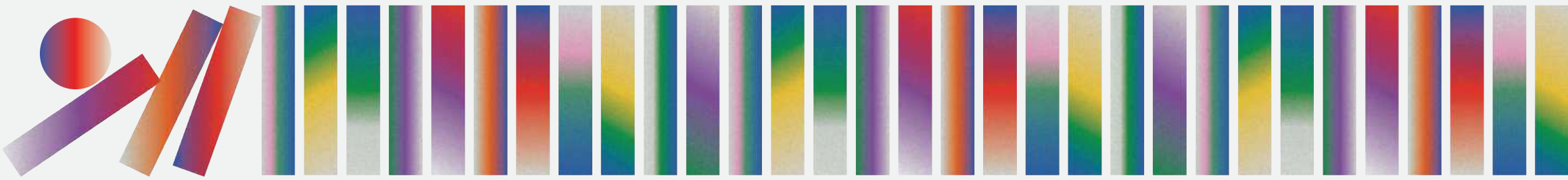
ployers and skilled professionals immediate relief. A \$100,000 fee on new H-1B petitions would have made US deployment significantly more expensive and created uncertainty for companies that need specialised talent on the ground," said Varun Singh, Fellow Member - Investment Migration Council (IMC) and Managing Director, XIPHIAS Immigration. However, he said, this is not a complete return to the old onsite-heavy model. While the ruling improves the economics of talent mobility, companies are likely to use the H-1B route more se-

lectively, especially for roles where client proximity, domain expertise, or specialised skills are essential. Meanwhile, Manish Dattari, Partner, Vialto Partners, argued that the Trump administration will likely appeal this ruling since it was a major part of their immigration agenda. There may be no final resolution to this matter for months. **LONG-TERM IMPACT** He added that the administration is introducing other measures that could affect foreign students, including a proposal requiring students to renew their status every

four years and a planned increase in H-1B prevailing wage requirements. Singh said the ruling is positive for international students, particularly those in STEM, engineering, and business programmes, as it removes a potential \$100,000 cost burden for employers sponsoring. However, he cautioned that it does not guarantee employment or long-term immigration success, noting that factors such as the H-1B lottery, employer sponsorship, salary thresholds, sector demand, and broader economic conditions will continue to influence job prospects.



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